Manual

Every topic Atlas answers from, in one place: search it, or read it through.
167 topics in 13 groups

Getting started

The app at a glance

The tabs along the top

Tessellate has seven tabs along the top. Dashboard: your day at a glance and quick actions. Notes: capture and your notes list. Chat: ask and let the agent act on your notes. Graph: how notes connect. Library: documents, whiteboards, mind maps, files and everything else in one place. Timeline: everything by date. Reminders: what is due. Settings (the gear, or Ctrl+,) holds the rest, and Atlas the guide (this chat) answers how-to questions from any tab. Press m then a letter to jump between tabs (o opens the OCR workspace), and Settings, Help starts the guided tour.

First steps and the sample notebook

Dashboard, Start in three steps

A new notebook's Dashboard shows Start in three steps: 1. Your name, 2. Write a note, 3. Ask your notebook. Each is ticked when it is done, and none of them needs an AI model: Ask answers from your notes' own words, and saving your first note offers Ask about it beside Saved. Try a sample notebook adds eight example notes, tagged sample-notebook, to explore (ask "where is the spare key?", see two linked notes in the Graph); it is offered until you write your own first note. Remove the sample notes moves them all to the bin, where Restore brings one back, and takes away the categories they made. The steps leave once all three are done and the sample notes are gone, or with Hide these steps.

The guided tour

Settings, Help

The guided tour walks through the whole app a section at a time, pointing at the real controls. Start it from Settings, Help and guide: Start the tour for all of it, or a part's row, its name over what it covers, to start there and carry on to the next; Back and Next move through it, and Finish ends it whenever you like. The search box under Welcome and tours in Settings, Help keeps only the topics that hold every word you type, with the words marked; Esc clears it.

Atlas, the guide

Status bar, the compass (Ctrl+Shift+H)

Atlas is this app's in-app guide, named for a book of maps. It answers how-to questions about Tessellate itself from the app's own help: where a feature lives, what a setting does, which tab to be on. It answers on the utility model in Settings, Models while smart model routing is on, on the chat model while that is off, and Settings, Models can give the guide a model of its own. With no model running it still answers from the help: Atlas's answer is put together for your question, and the From the help tab above it shows the topic word for word. It cannot read your notes or documents (ask the Chat or Ask tab for those), and nothing said to it is saved: the conversation is gone on reload, and "New chat" clears it now. It is reachable from the status bar on every tab, from the head of every Settings pane, from the command palette (Ask the Guide), from the Help pane in Settings and, on a phone, from More. An answer's open button lands on the control it is about, ringed.

The manual

Settings, Help, Open the manual

The manual is every topic Atlas answers from, on one page: Settings, Help, Open the manual, or Open the manual in the Guide's ... menu. The contents on the left jump to a group, the search box keeps only the topics that hold every word you type or what the words mean ("trash" keeps the bin's topic), those whose name holds them first, and the printer button prints what is shown (or saves it as a PDF). It is made from the Guide's own topics, so the two never disagree. What changed in each version is under Settings, About, What's new.

Hidden features and power keys

Everywhere

Hidden features and power keys. Ctrl+K is the command palette (jump anywhere, run an action), Ctrl+P is Find anything (notes, files and actions), and ? lists every shortcut, which Settings, Keyboard shortcuts rebinds. Press m then a letter to jump: d (Dashboard), n (Notes), c (Chat), g (Graph), l (Library), t (Timeline), r (Reminders), o (OCR workspace); or to act: s (Settings), q (Quick sketch), v (Record a meeting), a (Guide), p (Popup agent). A second m or Esc closes the panel. Ctrl+Shift+A opens the agent over any tab, Ctrl+Shift+H asks Atlas about the app, Ctrl+J writes at the cursor, Ctrl+Shift+E acts on selected text (so does a right-click on the selection), Ctrl+Shift+K opens the quick sketch pad, and Ctrl+Alt+R reloads the app clearing cached files. Every menu works from the keyboard: the arrows move, Home and End jump, Enter picks and Esc closes. Select in Notes, the Timeline and the Library acts on many items at once, the notes filter takes tag:, cat: and is: operators, the dashboard's ... menu has Tools & features, which lists everything the app can do, and each section's ? explains itself.

Keyboard shortcuts

Settings, Keyboard shortcuts

Press ? for the full list; Settings, Keyboard shortcuts rebinds any of them (press a shortcut's keys, then the keys you want; type in the field above the list to find one), and on a Mac Cmd works in place of Ctrl. A button with a shortcut shows it in its tooltip, in your own binding. Everywhere: Ctrl+K the command palette, Ctrl+P find anything, Ctrl+F find on this page, / jump to search (the chat box on Chat), Ctrl+Z undo, Ctrl+Shift+Z redo (on a phone, More then Commands opens the palette), Alt+Left and Alt+Right back and forward, a double-click on Notes or Library in the top bar back to its first sub-tab, Ctrl+, settings, Ctrl+Shift+L light or dark, Ctrl+Shift+Y show or hide the companion, Ctrl+Alt+R reload clearing cached files. Make: Ctrl+Shift+N a new note, Alt+N a quick note saved without leaving the page, Ctrl+Shift+D a new document, Ctrl+D today's note, Ctrl+Shift+V paste what you copied as a new note, Ctrl+Shift+R record a meeting, Alt+L the other devices panel, Ctrl+Shift+K the quick sketch pad, Ctrl+Shift+B the whiteboard. Writing: Ctrl+S save, Ctrl+/ the blocks and commands menu (in a document it comments the line instead), Ctrl+J Atlas writes at the cursor, Ctrl+Shift+E actions for the selected text (a right-click on the selection brings its popup back). AI: Ctrl+Shift+A the popup agent, Ctrl+Shift+H ask Atlas about the app, Ctrl+Shift+O a new chat, Ctrl+Shift+G agent mode on or off, Ctrl+. stop the answer, Ctrl+Shift+P clip a note to your next question. Press m then a letter to jump to a tab; the panel that appears lists Go to and Do with each letter beside its name, marks the tab you are on, and takes a click as well.

The command palette

Ctrl+K

Ctrl/Cmd+K opens the command palette: jump to any tab or setting, or run a quick action (new note, new chat, back up now, toggle the theme, and more) without leaving the keyboard. It does not list your notes or documents: type what you are looking for and its last row, Search everything for, opens Find anything (Ctrl/Cmd+P) with the words already searched. Typed words also find every feature in Tools and features, every act Chat does (it opens Chat with the words started) and the matching settings, by what the words mean too ("trash" finds the bin, "keybord" the shortcuts); a word a letter out offers the nearest, and what you ran for the same words comes first next time (hover a row to see why it is where it is). It's a different box from the popup agent (Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+A): this one runs fixed commands, that one answers and acts on an open-ended request. Typed as a reminder ("remind me friday 9 dentist"), its first row is that reminder, with its chips under the box.

Find anything

Ctrl+P, or the magnifying glass in the status bar

Find anything (Ctrl+P, or the magnifying glass in the status bar) searches notes, files, documents, chats and actions in one box as you type: Enter opens the top result, the arrows move, Esc closes, and the star keeps the search as a row under Saved searches in the Notes sidebar. Sort has Best match, Group by category (a note under its category, the rest under their kind), Newest first and Oldest first. Its '?' lists the operators. It lists the command palette's actions too, so "dark" finds Toggle light/dark, after the notes and files. The command palette (Ctrl+K) sends what you type here: its last row, Search everything for, opens this box with the words already searched. As you type it suggests your recent searches, then note titles, tags and categories, with the best match in grey: Tab or Right takes it, and Settings, General, Search turns it off.

Finding where something is

Notes tab, Ask your notebook

Ask where something is, in Ask or Chat: "where is the bin", "I can't find dark mode", "how do I get to backups". The answer says where it lives and gives a Show me link that opens it and rings the control, as a row of Tools and features does. When two places could be meant, each has its own link. Any row of Tools and features, any Settings section and any tab can be found this way, typos and all.

Searching everything

Ctrl+P, or the dashboard's search box

Find anything (Ctrl+P, or the search box on the dashboard) looks through notes, documents, boards, mind maps, files, links, reminders, chats and recordings (by title and by what was said) at once, by your words and by meaning; each result wears its kind, and the chips narrow it to one. Operators: tag:work, in:work for a space, kind:chat, before:2026-01, after:2025-06-30, has:image, is:pinned, a "quoted phrase", and -word to leave something out. The star saves a search as a row in the Notes sidebar. A small typo that finds nothing is searched as the nearest word your notes use, and the line says "showing results for" it. When nothing matches, it says what was searched and offers one way on: every kind, a spelling, or the nearest feature. To narrow only the notes list, use Filter notes on the Your notes tab. Every search box suggests as you type: your recent searches first, then note titles, tags and categories that start with your words (a Library list's box: that list's own titles), with the best match in grey (Tab or Right takes it, Down and Up walk the list, Esc closes it). A recent search has its own x, the list's foot clears them, Settings, Import & export, Clear and forget clears every box's at once, and Settings, General, Search turns the suggestions off.

Every view has an address

The browser's address bar

Every view has its own address, such as #/notes/12, #/chat/45, #/docs/7, #/library/images or #/settings/appearance. A reload keeps the view, a bookmark or a pasted link opens it, the browser's Back and Forward walk the app's own history, and the window title names the view and what is open in it. To link to one thing, open its menu and choose Copy app link (notes, documents, boards, mind maps and chats have it): it copies an address that opens that thing while the app is running. Paste it into a note or a document and it becomes a link that opens in the same window. Copy wiki link is the other one: a [[link]] for pointing at a note or document from inside a note.

Finding your way round Settings

The gear in the top bar, or Ctrl+,

Settings opens from the gear in the top bar or Ctrl+,. Its sections are grouped: AI (Models, Search and index, Personas, Skills, Tools it can use, What it remembers, What it learned, Web search), Notebook (Profile, General, Templates, Import & export), Look and feel (Appearance, Keyboard shortcuts), Privacy and security (Account & security, Privacy), System (Packages, Background tasks, Logs) and Help and About. The search box at the top of the list finds a setting by any word in it or by what it does, with words that mean the same ("night" or "darker" finds the theme, "battery" the battery-efficient mode, "back up" Backups, "the little guy in the corner" the companion, and a slip such as "chnage pasword" the password), and lists the matching settings under it, each opening where it sits; with an embedding model on (Settings, Search and index), up to three more found by meaning follow under Close in meaning. A long section lists its groups under its own name in that list: press one to go to it, and the one you are reading is marked as you scroll. On a phone the section picker holds the same groups under the section you are in.

Resetting and moving your settings

Settings, Import & export, Your settings

A setting changed from its default shows a bar at its left edge and a reset button at the end of its row, which puts that one setting back; Reset N changes, in the section's title bar, puts back every changed setting in that section. Performance mode, Text size, Density, Zoom and the companion's size, marked On this device, are kept only on the device you set them on (a phone and a computer each have their own zoom); the rest, your colours and fonts included, are kept in your notebook and follow you to every browser you sign in from. Settings, Import & export, Your settings: Export settings saves every setting as one .json file (no notes in it); Import settings reads one back, applies each setting it can, adds its skills, personas and templates to yours by name, says which it skipped and why, and offers Undo.

Install as an app

Settings, About, Install as an app

Settings, About, Install as an app gives Tessellate its own window and icon, and adds it to your phone's share sheet, so a page or a selection shared to it lands in Capture. The button appears only when your browser offers the install and the app is not installed yet; on an iPhone, tap Share, then Add to Home Screen. It is the same app, still served by the copy running on this computer. When that copy is not running, the installed app shows a page saying Tessellate is not running on this computer, with a Retry button, never an empty notebook: open Tessellate from the Start menu or the launcher, then press Retry.

The name, formerly MemoryMap AI

Settings, About

Tessellate, formerly MemoryMap AI, is the same app under a new name. Only the name changed: your notes, settings, password and the folder they are kept in stay where they were, and an update keeps all of it. Settings, About shows the name and the version.

Writing notes

Capturing a note

Notes tab

Notes tab: type into "Capture a thought" and Save. A local AI files it into a category and suggests tags; you can re-file or edit anytime. Use a template, dictate with the microphone icon, sketch with the palette icon, or run "Improve" to proofread first. The Writing room has "Split into notes", which turns a block of pasted text into several AI-drafted, auto-linked notes.

Quick note

Alt+N, from any tab

Quick note (Alt+N, or Quick note in the command palette) opens a small box over whatever tab you are on: type, press Ctrl+Enter, and the note is saved and filed in the background while you stay where you were. Escape closes it and keeps the words for next time; Open in Capture moves them to the full composer. The dashboard's Quick capture saves the same way. A bare link pasted into Capture or Quick note offers its page as a note through the web clipper, only while web search is allowed. "Clear" (the eraser icon) is in every box you type into: Capture, with its title, tags and files, Quick note, Ask, Chat and the popup agent. It shows only while the box holds something, empties it, and Undo (in the toast, or beside the box in a popup) puts it all back.

Dates and tags read as you type

Reminders, Quick note, New meeting, Timeline search, the command palette

Quick add: where you type something dated or tagged (the Reminders box, Quick note, a new meeting's title, the Timeline's search and the command palette), what the words were read as shows as chips under the box as you type: a day, a time, a repeat, a person, a #tag, a window like "last week". Enter saves what the chips say. Press a chip to leave those words as words. When something needed is missing (a reminder with no time), it asks once and saves nothing until you add it, rather than guessing. In Quick note a day is an offer of a reminder on the note, used when pressed or when the note starts "remind me". On the Timeline, Enter turns a window into the From and To range and keeps the other words as the search. It all works with no AI model.

Offers while you write

Notes, Capture, or a note's Edit form

While you write a note (Capture, or a note's Edit form), offers show as chips under the box when you pause: a day in the text becomes Remind me (press it to set the reminder, with Undo), a sum written with a wrong answer shows the right one (press it to put it in), and so does a Total: line under a column of amounts that does not add up; a name another note opens with becomes a [[link]], and File in names the category with its reason beside it. Nothing is offered on quoted words: text in quotation marks, a code span or block, or a quote line. At most five show at once. It all works with no AI model.

Autocorrect

Settings, General, Writing

Autocorrect fixes a clear typo, such as teh, as you finish the word, in the note boxes, the chat and Ask composers and the titles. The corrected word is underlined for five seconds: click it to put back what you typed, or press Backspace or Ctrl+Z straight after, and the toast carries Undo too. A word you put back is left alone for the rest of the session, and a word in your dictionary never changes. It never runs in code, links, tags or search boxes. Turn it off in Settings, General, Writing; a document has its own switch in the editor's ... menu.

Sharing a note

A note's menu, Download .md

Three ways, none through a server: the note's menu, Download .md, saves it as a Markdown file to send; copy its address (every view has one) for anyone opening this notebook with you; or let them open the notebook from their phone or computer on your network (Settings, Account & security, Other devices).

Capture from anywhere

Settings, Keyboard shortcuts, Capture from anywhere

Settings, Keyboard shortcuts, Capture from anywhere shows the command for this install (memorymap --capture, with its full path) and a Copy button. Give that command a key in your system's own keyboard settings: on Windows a desktop shortcut with it as the target and a Shortcut key, on macOS a Shortcuts action, on Linux a custom keyboard shortcut. Pressing the key over any app opens a one-line box on the Tessellate that is already running; Enter saves the note, filed like any other, and the box closes. On a phone, Share to Tessellate does the same.

Saving while the server is away

Notes tab, above Capture

A note saved while the Tessellate server is not answering (from Capture, Save as draft, Quick note or the dashboard's Quick capture) is kept on this device rather than lost, and is sent by itself when the server is back. It sits at the top of the notes list as a card marked Waiting to save, and a notice above Capture counts what is waiting, with Try now to send it at once. A note sent twice is still saved once. An edit left unsaved in a note's form is kept on this device too: after a reload or a closed window, a message offers Open them to carry on. A document's last words before a reload are kept the same way, and Put them back returns them when that document opens.

Pictures and files in a note

Capture, or a note being edited

Paste a picture into Capture or a note being edited, or drop a file on it, and it is kept with the note. An attached file is one card everywhere (the note, Capture, a document, the graph and the Timeline): the picture or a kind icon, its name, kind, size and date. Click the card to open it; its ... menu has Open, Download, Rename, Describe with AI, Edit description, Annotate a copy, Copy as a link and Remove. Removing a file can be undone, and the upload is only deleted once nothing else uses it.

Notes keys, filters and selection

Notes tab

Notes keys and controls. In Capture a thought, Ctrl+Enter saves, / (or Ctrl+/) opens the blocks and commands menu, Ctrl+J asks Atlas to write at the cursor, and selecting text shows an actions menu (Ctrl+Shift+E from the keyboard). From anywhere, Ctrl+Shift+N starts a note, Ctrl+D opens today's note and Ctrl+Shift+R records a meeting. In the list, Up and Down move note to note and Tab walks that note's buttons. The filter box understands, with no AI: two words (both, in any order), "a quoted phrase", tag:work, cat:recipes, #tag, title:, in:, before: and after: (a date such as 2026-09), is:favourite, is:pinned, is:private, is:linked, is:untagged, is:draft, tags:<2 (also <=, > and >=), has:link (also file, image or reminder), space:work and kind:note (asked of the search engine), and -word to leave a word out. is:review lists the filings to check (Atlas's estimate is under 50%, or it left the note in Uncategorised), each with Accept, Refile and Split; the Categories widget on the dashboard counts them. Select ticks several notes to move to a category, tag or delete together, and Select all ticks the whole page; the selection bar's Tags adds or removes tags on every selected note, and its ... menu adds to or removes from Favourites, archives, publishes drafts, removes a tag, moves them to another space or exports them as Markdown, each undoable. In Agent mode, Atlas can move chosen notes to a category or a space once you confirm, and Undo puts them back. Editing a note shows its words and reading time beside Save.

Sorting and browsing notes

Notes tab, Your notes

Sort notes: Newest first, Oldest first, Recently edited, A to Z ("note 2" before "note 10"), Most used or Forgotten first; the choice is remembered. A note's menu has Copy wiki link to paste a [[link]] to it into another note, and Copy app link for an address that opens it in the app. Editing a note has the title, a line of properties and the text in one box: the category is its chip with a menu, tags are chips after it (Add tag: Enter or a comma adds one, pressing one removes it), and the formatting icons sit above the text, the rest behind More. Related notes fold into one "suggested links" line until you open it. The foot has Attach a link (pick a saved bookmark) and the word count at the left and Cancel and Save at the right. On a focused note, F2 edits it, Delete deletes it, and Home and End jump to the ends of the list. In a window 1280 wide or more, the note you are reading (the one you clicked, else the one in view as you scroll) has a Connections column beside the list: the notes it links to, the notes that link to it with the sentence each says it in, "Mentioned, not linked" (notes and documents that name it without a link; Link turns those words into a [[link]], and is greyed out when the name has a square bracket in it, which a [[link]] cannot hold), and "Forgotten, and close to this". The note's Connections sheet shows the same, with its rows as a quiet list (a glyph, the title, a muted line for the kind or day) under a row of count chips, and on a wide window an Open in the sidebar button that docks it as this column.

A note's history

A note's menu, History

A note's History (in its menu) lists every change and whose it was: You, Atlas, or You and Atlas (a save that took an Improve writing suggestion), with the exact time on hover, and any earlier version can be put back; Then and now on an earlier version sets what it said against what the note says today, sentence by sentence (Changed, No longer says, Says now). In Ask, the clock button answers from your notes as they were on a day you pick, and Back to now returns to today. It also says who filed the note and how sure, and a change made by an AI tool names the model that made it. When the same note or document is edited in two windows, a save over text changed elsewhere is refused and you choose: keep your version, take the other one, or compare the two first.

Linking notes

Type [[in a note

Link one note to another by typing [[and the start of its title, then picking it from the list. The link shows on both notes as a connection, with a menu to add a reason, open or remove it. Atlas also suggests links as you write, and every note's menu has Link to. The Graph draws all of them. A note's menu also has Copy wiki link (a [[link]] for another note) and Copy app link (an address that opens the note in the app). Delete the [[name]] and its link goes with it; rename a note and a toast offers to rename the [[links]] other notes have to it. A note's Connections show the sentence each linking note says it in, and "Mentioned, not linked" with a Link button (greyed out, with the reason, for a note whose opening line has a square bracket in it, which a [[link]] cannot hold). Suggestions (Find links to add on the Dashboard's Loose ends, Suggest links in the Graph's options, or the command palette) is one sheet of four kinds: Links lists pairs worth connecting with every reason (similar wording, people or things both name, a note both link with, a rare tag both carry) and how sure it is (Link all above 70% in the head links every pair at least that sure, after asking); Tensions, notes that may disagree; Names, one person or thing named two ways, with Merge; and Link types, a link whose own sentence says "for example" or "continues". Accepting or dismissing any of them teaches it which reasons to trust in your notebook, and a dismissed one does not come back. A link's ⋮ has Kind and properties: a kind says what the link is (Supports, Part of, your own) and reads from the other note by its other name (Supported by, Has part); Kinds of link in the command palette adds, renames and deletes your own. The assistant can link two notes with any of these kinds too, yours included.

Favourites

A note's star

Starring a note makes it a favourite, a parallel way to keep important notes close, separate from categories or tags. Favourites show in the sidebar, filter in the Library, and can sit in their own Dashboard widget.

Templates

Settings, Templates

Capture has templates: pick one from No template above the box and the note starts with its outline. Save your own from Settings, Templates (New template in the pane's bar), where Draft with Atlas writes a template from its name and one line (press it again for another version; nothing is saved until you add it). The picker's Manage templates opens that page. A new document offers its own gallery of templates too: writing ones, and code ones that open in the code view (a Python script, a command line tool, a FastAPI endpoint, JavaScript with tests, an HTML page, a SQL schema, a README, a notebook of cells and a p5.js sketch).

Writing room

Notes tab, Writing room

Notes tab, Writing room: pick what to write (draft a note, continue or rewrite the draft, bullets to prose, prose to bullets, or translate), add notes as sources if you want it grounded in them, and press Write. The draft stays in the box to edit; save it as a note when it reads right. Which model writes is set on the same row, or in Settings, Models.

Translating

Notes tab, Writing room

The Writing room translates: put the text in the box and press Translate, or pick a language under Translate into in the menu beside Draft. The local model keeps every fact, name, number and the markdown, and leaves code and links alone. It needs a model connected. With no model, Translate this in the command palette turns a selected passage from English into Spanish on this computer once Translate offline is installed in Settings, Packages.

Translate this, offline

Command palette, Translate this

Select a passage in a note, a document or a reading and run Translate this from the command palette (Ctrl+K): it turns English into Spanish on this computer, with no model, in about a second, and Copy or Replace the selection puts it to use. With nothing selected it takes the whole editor you were in. It needs Translate offline, a 27 MB download in Settings, Packages (Languages); until then the row says so and opens that page. Other languages: the Writing room translates with your model.

Split text into notes

Notes tab, Writing room, More, Split into notes

Split into notes, in the More menu of the Writing room (Notes tab), turns a block of pasted free text into several AI-drafted, auto-linked notes instead of one long one. The Writing room is for turning rough, unstructured thoughts into a proper note before it's saved. A document's menu and a selection of cards on a board have Extract notes, which does the same for a document or for those cards.

Dictation, recordings and read aloud

Notes tab, the microphone; Library, Recordings

The microphone icon on the note composer dictates a note using local Whisper: nothing sent anywhere. "Record a meeting or lecture" (the command palette, Ctrl+Shift+R, or a meeting's Record into it) and "Voice note" keep the audio as a recording, saved every 10 seconds, even with no add-on; closing the recorder keeps it recording in a bar with Pause and Stop. The recorder's Microphone fold (and Settings, General, Microphone) chooses the input, noise suppression, echo cancellation and automatic gain, with a three-second test; Enhance on save there cuts rumble and evens the loudness, keeping the original until the transcript is saved. With the captions helper the words appear as you speak. With the Voice notes add-on it transcribes in the background (a notification says when it is done; Stop ends it) and the transcript is offered to save; saved, the recorder shows its first lines with Open. Library, Recordings plays them at 0.5 to 2x with a playhead and the time; drag the waveform to seek, press M to mark a moment with a comment, and Trim; a transcribed one lists its lines with their times (press one to play from it) and downloads them as SRT or VTT subtitles; with the AI on, each turn is labelled with who spoke, and a recording's menu has Rename a speaker to correct a name everywhere. Read-aloud plays a note or answer back to you.

How do I get live captions

Library, Recordings, Captions

Press Captions in Library, Recordings, or Live captions in a Voice note before you record; it is also in Tools and features, Audio, and in the command palette (Ctrl+K, type captions); Edit quick access can add it to the Dashboard as a tile. A bar appears over whatever you are looking at and writes what the microphone hears, on this computer, never over the internet. The bottom line is still being written; the three above it are done. Copy takes everything said so far, and Stop (or the palette row again) saves it as a note tagged captions. Translate, once the offline translator is installed (Settings, Packages), writes each finished line in Spanish under the captions; the note keeps what was said. Keep the audio of live captions (off until you turn it on, in Settings, General, Microphone) makes Stop save the audio too, in Library, Recordings, with the lines as its transcript. While a voice note records, the same captions write its words into the dialog as you speak, and the full transcript replaces them after. Captions need a local speech helper; its row in Settings, Packages says what is missing, and without one the row says so and nothing is recorded.

Meeting notes

Dashboard, New meeting; a meeting's meeting chip

New meeting (the Dashboard's Quick access, the command palette, Library's Create, Tools and features) asks for a title, when and who (a title like "Sync with Ana friday 2pm" fills When and Who from its chips), then opens the meeting as a note with Agenda, Notes, Decisions and Action items; Start and record does the same and starts transcribing straight into its Notes (Ctrl+Shift+R records too). Write an action item as "- [ ] Send the deck @Sam by Friday": @Name is its owner, the plain words its due. The meeting chip on the note (or its ... menu, Meeting) opens the meeting sheet: Remind me makes an action item a reminder, asking when if the line does not say; Summarise finds the decisions and action items in your notes, each with the words it came from, and adds them only when you press Add (Undo takes them back); Record into it transcribes on this machine and adds the transcript under Notes; Date and people changes when and who. All of it works with no AI: Summarise then reads lines saying decided, agreed, Action or TODO, or a name taking a task, and says so; with the AI on it rewords the same list. Every meeting is under Notes, Meetings, and sits on the Timeline at its own date. Its card shows the first agenda item, the decisions and the open action items; Show the whole note opens the text.

Filing, tags and categories

Tags and categories

A note's own row, or Capture's Filing menu

Atlas files each note into a category and suggests tags. Type #word anywhere in a note to tag it as you write, and the tags field completes from the tags you use (the arrows, then Enter or Tab, take one). Change either from the note's own row (press the category or Add tags), or choose a category yourself in Capture's Filing menu; while you type, Capture offers File under a category (with the reason on hover) beside the suggested tags, and pressing it sets the Filing menu. The categories are the sidebar of Your notes. Settings, Skills has Reorganise my categories and Clean up my tags for a bigger tidy.

How a note is filed

A note's card, beside its category

Each new note is filed into a category in the background. Its card shows how sure the filing was, for example 83% beside the category, and whether Atlas or your notebook's words filed it; the note's History names the model. That percentage is Atlas's own estimate, not the model's raw number: a small model often says 100% about everything, so nothing it picks reads above 95%, a pick your other notes disagree with is lowered, and so is a pick for a category with few notes. A filing under 50% shows check this, and the line under the note box offers the other categories as one-tap buttons; a note you filed yourself shows Filed by you and no percentage. With no AI model running, a note is filed by your other notes and a built-in topic list, only into a category you have, and says why (It mentions squat (Fitness), like the 9 notes in Gym). Unsure, it stays in Uncategorised with one-tap choices, and New: Fitness when none fits. Health, money and family notes wait for you unless File health, money and family notes by their words too is on in Settings, Background tasks. While a note shows Filing, its chip offers File by meaning now, Leave it where it is and File it myself, and Stop in Settings, Background tasks files every waiting note by meaning. A note you file yourself is never moved by a late answer, and moving notes by hand teaches the filing where things go. In Settings, Background tasks, Load the search model when the app starts chooses when filing by meaning gets ready: at launch, or on the first note, which then waits a few seconds. Let the search model go after an idle hour frees its memory when nothing has been searched or filed for an hour; the next search loads it again. Filing style (Settings, Background tasks) files by topic, by project or by time. Filings Atlas was unsure of wait in is:review, with Accept the filing on the note's menu.

Suggested tags

A note's card

The tags Atlas suggested when it filed a note stay on the note's card as "+ tag": one press adds the tag, and its x stops suggesting it (Undo in the notice brings it back, and the note's Edit form lists the ones turned down under Not suggested, each one press from coming back). With no AI running they come from your own tags: the ones the note names ("stats" finds statistics), its title and first line first, then those on the notes most like it and the notes it links to. Words in quotation marks and a scan's footer do not count. Either way a tag is offered only when the note has a word for it, at most three, and pointing at one says which word. A tag turned down on three notes is offered less everywhere; Manage tags lists it under Turned down, with Offer again. Tag and file with Atlas and Capture, while you type, suggest the same way. A note with fewer than three tags shows a quiet "+ Tag" after them: it opens up to three suggested tags as one-press chips above a field for your own. Its ... menu has "Don't suggest tags for this note", which stops the suggestions on that note alone (Undo in the notice brings them back, as does "Suggest tags for this note again" in the same menu).

Managing tags

Notes tab, the ... menu, Manage tags

The tag manager lists every tag with how many notes use it. Open it from the Notes ... menu (Manage tags), the Tags row in the notes sidebar, Settings or the command palette. Rename a tag, merge it into another, or remove it from all notes, one or several at a time; each change shows in the notes' history and has one Undo. Sort it by name, by notes or by the tag used most recently; Used once lists the tags only one note carries; tags that look like one (idea and ideas, to-do and todo) are offered as one Merge above the list, and the count after a tag shows its notes. Right-click a tag chip (or press the menu key on it) for Show notes, Rename in all notes, Remove from this note and Manage tags. The selection bar's Tags adds or removes tags on every selected note at once.

Managing categories

Notes tab, the Categories head in the sidebar

Manage categories (the Categories head in the notes sidebar, a category's ... menu, Settings or the command palette) makes one (New category), renames, merges (a category's menu, Merge into), splits and deletes categories, asking where the notes go; every change can be undone, and deleting one can always keep its notes in Uncategorised. A split can be suggested from the notes' tags or by Atlas, which reads the notes and proposes named groups to review. Colour gives a category one of twelve swatches (or Automatic), shown on its dots, chips, graph nodes, the Timeline and the Dashboard; select several to colour, merge or delete them together, with one question and one Undo. Sort by name, notes or the one used most recently, Empty lists the ones with no notes, Tidy suggestions offer names alike (in spelling or meaning) as one Merge and categories empty for thirty days to Remove, Not these never asks about a pair again, and the count after a name shows its notes. A category chip on a note opens Show notes in the category, Move to another category and Manage categories; dragging a note's category label onto another category moves it too.

Tidy: reviews with no AI

Notes tab, the broom in the dock

Tidy is the broom in the Notes dock, beside the search help; the number on it is how many things its reviews found. It opens on an overview of all eleven reviews, each a rule that needs no AI, with its count and one line on what it finds, the ones with nothing to tidy last; press a row to open that review and its back button to return to the overview. The reviews: Links to explain (Add reasons gives a link that only says similar in meaning what the two notes share, a tag, a name or a week), Weak automatic links (Remove links), Tags Atlas added (tags written by Atlas or a background pass, never changed by you, that fit their note poorly; Remove tags), Tags used once (Remove tags), Tags that look alike (Merge tags), Notes without a category (Move notes, to the category their words point to), Near-duplicate notes (Merge notes), Categories that overlap (Merge categories), Category names (Rename), Empty or very short notes (Move to bin) and Reminders long past (Mark done). Each review's description says what its button will change. A row's cross dismisses it for good (Undo restores it). Tick the rows (each says why it is listed and what the button will do), then press the button; one Undo puts the batch back, from the toast, Ctrl+Z or Recent runs. Apply automatically runs a review after each note is filed; merging, renaming, binning and removing tags used once never run on their own. Links to explain also has Add reasons to all in the background, a job you can stop in Settings, Background tasks. The command palette and Tools and features open Tidy too, and new links already say what their notes share when they can. Under the overview, Patterns says what the notes measure (golf 4 times since 5 September), each with Confirm, which keeps it as your own word from then on, and Not right, which never shows it or anything like it again;

Asking Atlas

Asking and chatting

Chat tab, or Ctrl+Shift+A over any tab

"Ask your notebook" (Notes tab) and the Chat tab both answer from saved notes, with the raw notes shown beside the answer; in Ask, Enter asks and Escape clears the question, and the clock button answers from your notes as they were on a day you pick. Its Use AI switch picks who answers: off, the answer is From your notes, quoted from your notes' own sentences with no AI, and it is the answer when no model runs, in Ask and in Chat. Sums, conversions (at the dated rates named), the time and days until a date are worked out, model or not; "what did I do last week" lists that week's notes; short follow-ups (and last week?, why?, shorter, no, the gym one) read against the question before; a cited board, map or document opens in its own place. With no model, Chat also acts (remind me to..., pin or delete the X note), with Undo. A counting question in Ask (how many notes per category this month) also gets a chart from your notes, with its numbers and Save as PNG. A note's ... menu has Explain this note: read aloud, then what it links to and why. Agent mode (a toggle in Chat) lets the assistant use its tools to search, link, tag, organise and create, destructive actions always ask first, and after it reads a web page or a clipped or imported note, so does every change and web request. Conversations save and rename in the sidebar; the same agent pops open over any tab with Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+A (from More on a phone), runs with no model, and Ctrl+Z takes back its last write. While an answer is coming, the line under it says what is happening: Reaching Atlas, Reading your notes, Waking the model, Atlas is thinking, Atlas is writing, or Atlas followed by the tool's name, or with no model Working it out without a model; with Progress indicators set to Still, without the dots.

Answers from your notes, no AI

Notes tab, Ask, the Use AI switch

Ask on the Notes tab has a Use AI switch beside its title. On, your model writes the answer; off, the answer is From your notes, with no AI. It opens with the answer, or for a topic with how many notes and over which days (You have four notes about uni, 17 July to 4 August), then tells each note in a sentence (In your first psych lecture you learned ...) or under a bold label, one source mark that lights its note. It says what the notes do not cover yet (Nothing yet on due dates), how alone or stale a fact is (Nothing on bench since September), and can end with one offer you press (a reminder, a checklist or a note, with Undo); next week is said as the day it meant. A count leads with its figure, a person is a card, a comparison a table, what is left a checklist; past five lines, Show more. The ... by Copy keeps it as a note, a document or a mind map. Asked what it can do (can you search the web?), it says whether and how; it never searches. Tell me more, or the second one, follows on from the answer before. The Chat tab answers the same way whenever no model is running: its box stays open, and Agent mode is greyed unless the Needle extra can run it (the app's own tools go first). Every sentence is quoted from a note and cited like any answer; the app adds only the joining words and the counts and dates it measured, names two notes that may disagree, and says which of your words none of the notes found mention. In Ask the chip over the answer reads From your notes; in Chat the reply's head reads Atlas, from your notes (Atlas and the model's name when a model wrote it). The No model connected line above the Chat box and the Ask box has a close button (the small x at its end): it hides that line until the next time you start the app, a new session, and connecting a model in Settings, Models always brings the answers back.

Chat keys and controls

Chat tab

Chat keys and controls. Enter sends, Shift+Enter starts a new line; Escape or Ctrl+. stops the answer, Ctrl+Shift+O starts a new chat, Ctrl+Shift+G turns agent mode on or off, Ctrl+Shift+P clips a note to your next question, and Ctrl+Shift+A opens the same agent over any tab. Typing / in the box opens the chat menu: attach a note, a document, a file or an image, upload one, Web search, Plan first, Skills, and Agent or Ask mode. The note button beside the box opens Attach: a tab each for notes, documents, files, images and mind maps, with a search; the arrows move, Space ticks, Enter is Done. Each message's menu can copy it, edit your question, regenerate from here, save it as a note or read it aloud. The header can fork the conversation, compress the earlier messages (Undo goes back), show how full the model's context is (press it for what fills it, Compact earlier messages and Change the window, the size set in Settings, Models), switch the model, and export the chat as Markdown. A numbered source mark in an answer shows a preview of its note on hover or focus (the passage it came from, whether it supports the sentence or only partly, and three bars for why it was chosen: Words it shares, Meaning, Links), a press keeps it open, and Open note goes there. A note's name in square brackets shows it on hover; a press opens it. The button at the end of Grounded in says how many sentences came from your notes ("9 of 11 from your notes"); it opens the evidence, each sentence beside the passage it came from, and No note says this beside the ones none backs. When an agent answer takes more than one step, a checklist above it ticks off each round, what it searched or read, then the answer. A number or a name in an answer that nothing it read contains gets a heads-up under the answer, so check it before relying on it.

Things Chat does for you

Chat tab

Chat does these from one sentence, with no model. Set a reminder: "remind me to call mum on Friday at 9". Tag notes: "tag the knife note with kitchen". Take a tag off: "remove the tag urgent from the boiler note". Move notes to a category: "move the sourdough note to Cooking". Make a new note: "note: buy milk and eggs". Start a meeting: "start a meeting". Pin a note: "pin the dentist note". Unpin a note: "unpin the dentist note". Link two notes: "link the gym note to the running note". Unlink two notes: "unlink the gym note from the running note". Rename a note: "rename the gym note to Strength plan". Add a line to a note: "add buy chalk to the gym note". Delete a note: "delete the boiler note". Find a note: "find my note about the passport". Open a note: "open the note about the boiler". Open a part of the app: "open settings". Summarise notes: "summarise my gym notes". These wait for Confirm: tag notes, take a tag off, move notes to a category, link two notes, unlink two notes, rename a note, add a line to a note, delete a note. The rest run at once. Undo on the card, or Ctrl+Z, takes any of them back.

Calling Atlas by any name

Chat tab

Call Atlas whatever you like, a nickname or a word you just made up: "hey lil bro, what's on today", "what's due this week, broski". The name is taken off before the question is read, so it is never searched or corrected. A message that is only a name is a call: Atlas answers and offers three things to ask.

Where a follow-up came from

Chat tab, or Ask in the Notes tab, under an answer

Under a finished answer, Chat offers Next questions and Ask offers Ask next. A question sent from one of them shows a Follow-up of line above it: each earlier question in the chain, as a link. In Chat a link scrolls to that question and lights it; in Ask, which shows one answer at a time, it opens that earlier answer under the line, and a second press folds it. The line is saved with the chat, so it is there when the chat is reopened. A question you type yourself starts a new chain. A short follow-up you type (what about running?, and Oppenheimer?, the second one) is answered like a first question; no, the data structures one stays chosen for the next shorter; and tell me more, once everything is said, says that is all your notes hold. When one word means two things in your notes (python the code, python the snake), the answer takes the newer and offers one chip for the other.

Why this answer

Notes tab, Ask, under an answer

Under an answer in Ask, Why this answer opens the lines that made it, each with the seconds since you asked: what the question was read as, what was searched and how many notes matched, who wrote it (Atlas from your notes with no model, or the model by name, and whether it was handed the app's own answer as a fact), the shape it took, how many of the matching notes it cites, and how long it took.

Wrong fact and Pin as true

Ask or Chat, a numbered mark in an answer

Press a numbered mark in an answer: under the note's words, Is this line right? has Confirm and Not right. Not right leaves those sentences of the note out of every answer from the next one on, and no pattern that quotes them is offered. Confirm pins them as true: answers say them as your word, with the day you pinned them, and a model reads them that way too. Each goes on the undo stack, and lists in Settings, What it learned (Marked wrong or Pinned as true), where Delete takes it back. The note itself is never changed.

Pictures in answers

Chat tab, or Ask in the Notes tab, Grounded in

When an answer in Chat or Ask draws on a note with pictures or sketches, the note's numbered chip under Grounded in has up to three small pictures beside it (a +n says there are more). The chip opens the note; a picture opens in the image viewer, with its caption and the text read off it. Atlas can also place a picture inside its answer by writing [picture 2] for note 2 ([picture 2.2] for its second): it appears as a figure under the paragraph, with its caption and a From note 2 link that opens the note, and a click opens the image viewer. Atlas shows one only when seeing it answers or shows the point; ask for the picture (show me the sketch) and a cited note's picture appears even without the token. At most three figures an answer; reopening the chat draws them again.

Dates and recent notes in answers

Chat tab, or Ask on the Notes tab

Ask and Chat read a note's time words as the note meant them: "this Friday" in a note written two weeks ago is that Friday, with its date, not this week's, and the weekly digest reads them the same way. Questions about recency are answered from the notebook rather than by searching for the words: "What have I saved recently?", "what did I write lately" or "my last note" lists your newest notes newest first, each cited with when it was written, and works with no AI model running.

Questions about your notebook

Chat tab, or Ask on the Notes tab

You can ask about the notebook itself, not just what is in it: "what are my most common tags", "which categories have the most notes", "how many notes do I have", "how many notes have no tags", "which are my most linked notes", "when do I write most". These are counted from your data rather than generated, so the numbers are exact, the answer is instant, and it works even with no AI model running at all. Private and binned notes are never counted. Your own abbreviations are learned the same way: when a note names Cloud Computing beside CC, asking about CC finds both, and "what does CC stand for?" says which note told it. "Summarise this" sums up the note you have open, or the category the sidebar is filtered to; "summarise Travel" reads every note in that category.

Notes that disagree

Dashboard tab

Tessellate can look for places where two of your notes disagree, a decision you reversed, a fact you later corrected, and show them side by side with the dates, so you can see which is current. It runs on demand rather than constantly, because it is a real pass over the notebook with the local model. It never edits anything: the point is to show you the pair and let you decide. Open Suggestions (the Tensions widget's Review disagreements, or the command palette), choose Tensions and press Start the review. What a review or the overnight pass already found stays found: the Tensions widget lists the pairs still to decide, each with what it is about and which model found it when, and its buttons open either note, link the two as contradicting, or dismiss the pair for good. A review only reads pairs it has not read before.

Skills

Settings, Skills

Skills are one-click requests shown above the chat box (e.g. "Summarise my week"). Built-in skills ship with the app; add your own in Settings, Skills (New skill in the pane's bar opens the form). A skill can use the AI's tools, so it does the work rather than just describing it. A skill can also be a Markdown file saved in the skills folder that Settings, Skills names; it is listed without a restart.

Personas

Settings, Personas

A persona changes how Atlas talks, not what it knows: answers stay grounded in your notes whichever one is active. Pick one in the Chat tab; edit the built-ins or write your own in Settings, Personas (New persona in the pane's bar), where {ai_name} in your text becomes Atlas's name.

Answer style

Settings, Personas, Answer style

Settings, Personas, Answer style: how Atlas words its answers, Friendly (the default), Concise or Detailed, whichever persona is active. Below it, How Atlas sounds with no model picks the voice it answers from your notes in without a model: Warm and concise (the default), Neutral, Playful or Plain, with a sample under it. The facts and the sources are the same in every voice. What Atlas adds of its own sets whether an answer about a topic ends with a pattern from your notes: Nothing, One line (the default) or Everything it finds; each Not right raises the bar.

What it remembers

Settings, What it remembers

Tessellate can pick up small facts and preferences as you write and chat, always asking first, never assumed. Accept or decline each suggestion right in the chat, and review or forget anything it has learned in Settings, What it remembers.

What it learned

Settings, What it learned

Settings, What it learned is what Atlas worked out by itself while reading your notes (a claim a note makes, a question it leaves open, two claims in different notes that disagree, a question a later note answers), where What it remembers is what you told it. The Dashboard's While you were away card counts each kind from the last read; a pair shows the other sentence under it, a button to open the other note and, for a disagreement, one to link the two notes as disagreeing. Every row says which note it came from, which model decided it and how sure it was. Edit a row and no later run overwrites it; delete one and it is never worked out again. What may run switches each kind off; Read my notes now runs it; Export what it learned and Forget everything learned act on all of it and never touch your notes. The Learned from you line under the title counts your corrections and gives filing accuracy, the share of the notes Atlas filed that you left where it put them, older half of the last 200 against newer.

Open questions

Notes tab, Questions

Notes, Questions lists the questions your notes ask in passing, your own ones only (not a quote, a prompt list, a script's line or a joke answered on the next line), found when Atlas reads your notes (Read notes now, or on its own with background tasks on), grouped by note, newest note first: Open, Answered or Dropped, picked in the bar with a count on each. A note that asks any says so on its card (2 open questions); pressing that shows only its questions. A row says when it was asked; when a later note answers it, the row says so with the sentence, and pressing that line opens the note. Mark answered asks which note answers it and links the two notes; Drop puts a question aside; Reopen brings either back. Ask about these opens Ask answering from the notes with open questions only (Ask all notes under the box goes back). The Dashboard's While you were away card counts the open ones and names the oldest.

Documents and code

Documents

Library tab, Documents

The document editor (opened from Library → Documents) has four views: Live (renders as you write), Source, Split and Read. Enter in the title moves to the body. Code files get line numbers, Tab/Shift+Tab indenting and Ctrl+/ commenting. "Check with AI" reviews a document for wording issues a spellchecker can't catch. The menu's Map the headings turns its headings into a new mind map. A mermaid code block (flowchart TD, A --> B, or the "/" menu's Flowchart) draws as a diagram in Read and Live and in a print; press it to edit its text, and any other Mermaid stays as code. Print or save as PDF first asks for the page size, orientation, margins and page numbers, and a plain Ctrl+P uses the last choice. In Live, drag the corner of a picture to resize it (or focus the corner and use the arrow keys), and its align button puts it left, centre or right. The status bar counts characters, words, lines and reading time the way the note composer does (an emoji is one character). Search documents reads a window: "harbor last week" finds the ones about the harbor edited in the last week.

Document editor keys and controls

Library tab, Documents

Document editor keys (Library, Documents; Ctrl+Shift+D starts one). While a document is open, Ctrl+K lists every document command and ? shows the ones with keys. Ctrl+S saves, Ctrl+B bold, Ctrl+I italic, Ctrl+E inline code, Ctrl+Shift+S strike through, Ctrl+1, Ctrl+2 and Ctrl+3 headings, Ctrl+Shift+8, Ctrl+Shift+7 and Ctrl+Shift+9 a bulleted, numbered and task list, Tab and Shift+Tab indent and outdent, Ctrl+/ comments the selection, Alt+Up / Alt+Down moves a section from the outline, and typing / opens the blocks menu. Ctrl+F finds and replaces (Enter next, Shift+Enter previous, Esc closes), Ctrl+Shift+F finds in every document, and Replace in every document (the ⋯ menu or Ctrl+K) replaces across them all, plain or a regular expression, as one undo step. Views: Edit, where Live renders as you write, Source is the markdown and Split puts a preview beside it, or Read. The sidebar's Outline lists the headings (with a filter when there are many), and headings fold. Focus mode (the corners button on the dock, or F11) hides everything but the page, with a small bar for the title, save state, a Sidebar button and Exit (Esc closes the sidebar, then Esc or F11 leaves). The formatting toolbar hides and comes back: while it is hidden, the Formatting button in the document's bar, Ctrl+Shift+X or the bar's More menu, Show formatting toolbar, brings it back. In a Live table the arrows keep the column, Enter goes to the cell below, and rows pasted from a spreadsheet fill the cells. Pasting from a web page, Word or Google Docs keeps headings, bold, italics, lists and links; Ctrl+Shift+V pastes plain text. With nothing selected, Ctrl+C and Ctrl+X copy and cut the whole line, and pasting that line puts it above the one you are on.

Document editor features

Library tab, Documents

Document editor features. The document's menus hold History (every version, and a way back to any), Connections, Extract notes, AI edit, a word goal, typewriter scrolling, dim all but this paragraph, serif for reading and full width. With no model connected, AI edit and Extract notes say why when pressed and offer Set up a model. Footnotes show as numbered notes at the foot in Read view, in print and in the HTML download. A page break (the / menu's Page break, written \newpage on its own line) starts what follows on a new page when the document is printed or saved as a PDF. Writing checks: spelling against your own dictionary, grammar checked on this machine, an accessibility check (a skipped heading level, an image with no description, link text like "click here"), Suggest changes (tracked changes to accept or reject one at a time or all at once), Read aloud (Esc stops), autocorrect, and word suggestions (Tab accepts). Word: Download as .docx is written in the app, nothing to install, and keeps headings, emphasis, links, nested lists, tables, code (with its language), pictures, and suggested changes as Word's tracked changes; a .docx added in the Library is read with its headings, nested lists, tables, code blocks and pictures kept, and one with tracked changes keeps them as suggestions to accept or reject; other downloads are .md, .html, a .zip with images, and print or save as PDF.

Callouts

Library tab, Documents

Callouts: type / in a document or a note and pick Note, Tip, Warning or another kind. The box is tinted by its kind and its icon names it; click the icon to change the kind or to make the box fold. The first line, after the icon, is the title, written like any text, and the lines under it are the body (an empty body says what goes there). Source view shows the markdown: > [!tip] Title.

A document's history

A document's ... menu, History

Documents keep a history. The ... menu → History lists every version the document has had, newest first, with who changed it (you, an AI edit, or a restore), how many words it gained or lost, and the opening of that version. Name this version keeps the text as it stands under a name (Named shows only those; a row's ... menu renames one). "Changes" shows a version side by side with the one after it on a wide window. "View" reads an old version without changing anything; "Restore" puts it back at once and keeps the version it replaced: Ctrl+Z or the toast's Undo returns the text you had. Rename, archive, a detached note or link and a dictionary word undo the same way. A stretch of editing counts as one entry rather than one per autosave. The AI panel has a separate "AI edits" log for reverting one specific suggestion the model made.

Spelling, grammar and wording

The document editor

The document editor checks spelling, spacing and sentence length as you write, and grammar (agreement, a or an, its or it's) with Harper, a grammar checker that runs on this computer; note boxes get the grammar check too, and the dictionary dialog turns it off. It also checks accessibility: a skipped heading level, an image with no description, link text like "click here". In Live view a flagged word is underlined: click or right-click it for corrections, "Add to dictionary" or "Ignore this for now". The Suggestions panel lists every finding; clicking one scrolls to it and opens its answers, the check on a row accepts its one clear fix and the crossed eye ignores it, and the arrow keys walk the rows. Fix applies every clear fix at once; the ... in the panel's head holds Check with AI, the Dictionary and which side the panel docks on. Where there is no mechanical fix, an awkward sentence, "Ask the AI for wordings" has the local model offer two or three alternatives to pick from. Nothing is changed until you choose it. Manage the dictionary and the British/American spelling preference from the editor's own dictionary dialog.

Code documents

Library tab, Documents

A document can be code: give it the extension (fix.py, index.html). You get syntax colours, error underlines listed in the Problems panel, hover notes, colour swatches, indent guides and brackets that close themselves. Spelling covers comments and strings only. Completions and snippets open as you type (the Code completions topic). HTML and CSS have Emmet: type ! or ul>li*3 and press Enter or Tab; the command palette (Ctrl+K) has Emmet wrap and balance inward or outward. Keys: Shift+Alt+F formats, Ctrl+/ toggles a line comment, Shift+Alt+A a block comment, Alt+Z wraps long lines, F8 and Shift+F8 step through problems, Alt+Enter offers quick fixes, F12 goes to a definition, Shift+F12 lists every use, Ctrl+Shift+F finds in every document, and Go to a symbol is in the palette. Ctrl+Shift+Enter runs the file (the Running code topic) in a sandbox, its output in a panel under the editor; F5 debugs it (the Debugging code topic: F9 a breakpoint, F10 steps over, F11 while debugging steps in (Focus mode otherwise), Shift+F11 steps out, Shift+F5 stops); Stop ends it, and the panel's top edge drags its height (kept for each tab). Blocks fold from the gutter (Ctrl+Shift+[and Ctrl+Shift+] fold and unfold, Ctrl+Alt+[and Ctrl+Alt+] all of them). Its tabs: Output, Problems, Tests, Console (Python or JavaScript, in what the run left) and Debug. Ctrl+J shows it, Ctrl+Shift+M Problems, Ctrl+Shift+Y the Console, Ctrl+Shift+D Debug; Ctrl+Shift+P or F1 runs a command by name, Ctrl+\ splits the editor, Ctrl+K Ctrl+S lists every key, and Outline follows the caret. Minimap (Editor and layout, off at first) maps the whole file; Compare with a saved version (palette) shows the changes inline, with Reject to put a hunk back.

Completions and snippets in code

A code document, as you type

Completions open as you type in a code document: Enter or Tab takes one, and the grey ghost text is taken with Tab. Snippets expand short words such as for, if, try, class, main or sout, and Tab walks their stops. In Python, a standard library module the file imports offers its names after the dot (math., os.path.), each with its signature, and pointing at one shows it. In a p5.js sketch (a file with setup or draw), p5's own names are offered with their arguments.

Running, previewing and testing code

A code document, Run

Run (Ctrl+Shift+Enter, beside Format) runs a code document in a sandbox with no network and none of your notes, and shows what it prints, its errors and their lines in the Output panel under the editor. JavaScript runs as it is (JSX in it becomes React.createElement calls); TypeScript runs with its types removed, not checked; SQL runs against a SQLite database made for the run, each statement's result a table, and a CSV document the query names is a table in it (Sales 2026.csv is sales_2026, its first row the columns); Python runs once Python is installed in Settings, Packages (until then Run is greyed and the line beside it goes there), and input() reads its lines from the panel's Input box. HTML, CSS (over a sample page), SVG and a p5.js sketch (New from a template, p5.js sketch) show as a page; Live in the panel refreshes it as you type (the panel's buttons are icons: point at one for its name). A file of tests (describe, it and expect in JavaScript or TypeScript; unittest or test_ functions in Python) runs its tests, each listed with its time and a failure underlined on its line; Run tests in the panel asks for them. The palette has Run the selected lines and Run the cell at the caret (between # %% markers). Stop ends a run; one still going after two seconds is listed in Activity, whose Stop ends it too. Beside Output, Problems lists every underline and Tests each test; the Console (Ctrl+Shift+Y) evaluates a line in what the run left, Python for a .py file and JavaScript for the rest, Up recalling the last. Debug (F5) steps JavaScript, TypeScript and Python; see the debugger.

Debugging code

A code document, the gutter beside a line number, F5

Debug runs a JavaScript, TypeScript or Python document to its first breakpoint and stops there. Click beside a line number (or press F9 on the line) for a breakpoint; right-click it to add a condition, and it stops only when that is true. A document keeps its breakpoints on this device after a reload. Press F5, or Start debugging in the run panel's Debug tab; the stopped line is lit, and the Debug tab shows Variables (the frame's names, then Globals; a list, dict or object opens into its items), Watch (type an expression under it; each stop evaluates it), the Call stack (a row goes to its line) and Breakpoints. F10 steps over a line, F11 into a call, Shift+F11 out of the function, F5 continues and Shift+F5 stops; the same five are buttons at the top of the tab. An error nothing catches stops on the line that raised it, with its traceback and the frame's variables. A Python file of tests debugs through its tests: a breakpoint inside one stops there, and the Tests tab lists each result. Python's input() asks in the panel mid-run. Python debugging needs a window that gives SharedArrayBuffer (the app's own does); JavaScript is stepped by an interpreter that reads ES5, so let, const, arrow functions and template strings are rewritten for it, and a class, destructuring or async code is named with its line and only Run takes it. A script that uses the page debugs against a stand-in document, so nothing is drawn.

The code panel: assistant and snippets

A code document, Assistant or Snippets (beside Run)

Assistant and Snippets (beside Run, on a code document) open the code panel beside the editor, a sheet on a phone. The Assistant tab works on the selected lines, or the whole file: Explain, Fix (the problem at the caret), Write tests, Refactor, or a question typed below them. A change comes back as a diff: Apply puts it in the editor, where one Ctrl+Z takes it out, and Reject leaves the file alone. With no model, Fix applies the quick fix, the tools row (Quick fix, Format, Run tests, Find usages) works as it is, a question those tools answer (format, run the tests, where a name is used, the symbols) runs the tool, and any other goes to the needle extra when it is installed; otherwise a Needs a model line links to Settings. Explain, Write tests, Refactor and the inline Ask bar (Ctrl+J) stay on screen, disabled, and a press says why. The Snippets tab lists the built-in library and your own snippets, this file's language first (Show every language for the rest); the search matches names, tags and languages, and #io matches the tag io. A row inserts at the caret and one Ctrl+Z takes it out; built-in rows have stops that Tab walks. The panel's Save keeps the selected code: #words in the name you give become its tags. Each of your own rows has a menu to insert, rename or retag, and delete; saving, renaming and deleting each undo. Snippets belong to the notebook, not to one document.

The margin reader

A document's menu, While you write, Margin reader

The margin reader reads with you while you write a document. Turn it on from the document's menu, While you write, Margin reader. A column to the right of the editor then shows at most three cards about the paragraph the caret is in, a moment after you stop typing: Repeats (you already wrote this in another note), Differs (the same thing with a different number or a not, or what the model judges a disagreement), Answers (it answers an open question from your notes), Date (a time in the paragraph, with Make a reminder) and Related. Each card has Open and Not this; nothing is ever written into your text. It is off until you turn it on, remembered on this device, and can be switched off everywhere in Settings, What it learned, What may run, Margin reader.

Boards and maps

Whiteboards

Library tab, Boards & maps

The whiteboard (Library, Boards & maps) is a pannable canvas for freehand sketches and note cards together. Freehand sketches also appear in the Library's Images sub-tab. A board's background colour and image are kept with the board. Board, Export saves a PNG (1x, 2x or 3x, with a transparent background if you like), SVG or PDF named after the board. Paste text from another app onto a board: a link becomes a link box, one line a text box, a list a grid of stickies. In the command palette over a board, say what to do with the selection (or the whole board): "arrange as a grid of 3", "put them in a row", "stack them", "align left", "space them evenly", "same width"; Undo takes it back. A sticky that names a day shows it as a chip at its foot; press it to set a reminder for a day still to come. Fit (Shift+1) goes into the canvas you can see, clear of an open sidebar, Format panel, top bar and tools dock, and refits when one opens or closes until you pan or zoom yourself. Drag an item to move it, or type its X and Y in the Format panel; the context bar over a selection, or the Format panel, changes its colour, line and words. Draw a link between cards with the connector (C), from one card to the other.

Whiteboard keys: tools and moving around

Library tab, Boards & maps

Whiteboard keys (Library, Boards & maps; Ctrl+Shift+B opens it). Tools: V or S select, H hand, K lasso, P pen, M highlighter, E eraser, B fill, L line, A arrow, R rectangle, O circle, G triangle, D diamond, T text, N sticky note, F frame, C connector (Shift+C curved), I image, X delete. The Shapes button's flyout also has a rounded rectangle, ellipse, hexagon, parallelogram, star, cylinder, cloud, speech bubble and block arrow. Moving around: the wheel or two fingers pan, Shift+wheel pans sideways, Ctrl+wheel or a pinch zooms, Space and drag pans, a drag to an edge pans, Ctrl+= and Ctrl+- zoom, Ctrl+0 is 100%, Shift+1 fits all, Shift+N shows the overview, / or Ctrl+F finds, Ctrl+H replaces, and Tab walks the board's items. Selection, menus and presenting are in Whiteboard selection and menus.

Whiteboard keys: selection, menus and presenting

Library tab, Boards & maps

Whiteboard selection and menus. Selection: Shift+click adds, Ctrl+A selects all, Ctrl+D duplicates, Alt and drag copies as you drag, Ctrl+V pastes at the pointer, the arrows nudge (Shift for further), Shift and drag keeps to one axis, Shift and a corner keeps proportions, Alt resizes from the centre; a move, resize or box drawn out shows guides and its size (Alt: none), [and] move one step back or forward, Ctrl+[and Ctrl+] to the back or front, Ctrl+G groups, Ctrl+Shift+G ungroups, Ctrl+Alt+C and Ctrl+Alt+V copy and paste a style, Delete (or a drop on the bin) removes, Esc cancels a drag or goes to Select. Double-click empty board for a text box, double-click a closed shape (or select it and press Enter) to write in it, right-click (or hold on touch) for the menu, double-click a line to bend it, and select a connector and press Label in its bar (or Enter) to label it. A frame's title drags it and what is inside it (Ctrl: the frame alone); its menu exports it or fits it to its contents, and a double-click on one of its resize handles fits that edge (a corner, two) to what it holds, with a margin. Ctrl+Shift+L locks the selection; Unlock is on the board's right-click menu. Right-click an item, Comment..., starts a thread; its count reopens it. View, Present frames: one frame at a time; ? shows every key; Ctrl+K finds any board action by name. Menus: Insert, Edit, Arrange (align, distribute, size, order, group, lock), View (panels, background, grid, snap, zoom; full screen on a phone) and Board (rename, new, export, kind, clear, delete, keys).

A board's history, and putting it back

A board, Board, History...

Board, History... (or Ctrl+K, History) puts a slider at the foot of the board. Drag it back, or press Left, Home and End, and the board is drawn as it was at each moment, a moment being a run of changes up to two minutes long; the bar says when and what it added, changed and removed. Nothing can be changed while the past is shown. Put back restores the whole board as it was then, and the second button only what was selected when History opened; either is one Undo step and is in the history too. Esc, or the slider's right end, comes back to now. Changes older than ninety days may be kept only in summary, and such a moment cannot be shown. Board, Snapshots... names the board as it is now (Snapshot and the time unless you type a name); each one shows its picture, and Restore puts the board back as one Undo step.

The board's library, layers and pages

A board, the Library button in its top bar

A board's sidebar (the Library button in its top bar, or the rail on its left edge) has four tabs: Library, Notes, Layers and Pages; a mind map's has Library, This map (its facts, its look, open every fold, lay it out again) and Outline. The Library starts with Templates (17 for boards, 15 for maps; see Board and map templates). Pages lists the board's frames in presentation order: drag a row or press Alt+Up and Alt+Down to reorder, Enter goes to the frame, P presents from it, double-click or F2 renames it, and its ⋯ menu has more. Layers starts with named layers: + adds one holding the selection; its eye and lock act on all of it. Tinted rows are selected on the board (the head counts them; Clear drops them), and a frame lists what it holds under its row. A locked item shows a lock when the pointer is on it; right-click it to unlock it. The Library holds built-in sets (General shapes, Flowchart, Arrows, Frames (a frame, a timeline lane and swimlanes in rows or columns) and 1,530 icons drawn as shapes), five draw.io sets (196 shapes with their own connection points), then Favourites, Recent and your own libraries; the search field finds any of them by name or tag. Click a tile or press Enter to place it in the middle of the view, drag it and it lands held where you grabbed it, or Shift+Enter to place it joined to what is selected; F stars it, and Shift+F10 or a right-click opens its menu (rename, tags, duplicate, move, delete). Saving your own is in Saving to the library.

Saving to the board's library

A board, Ctrl+Shift+S or right-click, Library

Saving to the library. To save your own: select things and press Ctrl+Shift+S, or right-click, Library, for a selection, a drawn shape, a style, a sticky or text preset, a palette of the selection's colours, or on a mind map a branch; Board, Save this board as a template keeps the whole board. New board then offers your templates beside the built-in ones. The library's ⋮ makes a new library, imports a library file and exports one. A placed item is an ordinary copy: changing the library later never changes a board. In Agent mode the assistant can search the library and place from it, draw shapes and frames, and move, edit or delete what is on a board, asking first.

Board and map templates

Library tab, Boards & maps, New, From a template

New, Whiteboard (the Boards and maps dock) opens Untitled board N, its name ready to type over in the top bar (Enter keeps it, Escape the old one). New, From a template (or Board, New board) opens one dialog: Board or Mind map in the tab strip under its title, the name, then the templates grouped by purpose (Plan and track, Weigh and decide, Find the cause, Meet and review, Study and create, then your own), each with its picture, and the chosen one drawn larger beside the list. A click chooses; Create, Enter or a double click makes it. A board's seventeen: Kanban, Weekly planner, Roadmap, Project brief, OKRs, SWOT analysis, Eisenhower matrix, Pros and cons, Lean canvas, 5 whys, Fishbone, Flowchart, Meeting notes, Retrospective, Study notes (Cornell), Mood board and User journey map. Each frame is a tinted panel with its title and a hint inside its top; drag the title to move the frame and what is in it, double-click it to rename. A map's fifteen, among them Brainstorm, Decision, Project plan, Cause and effect, Pros and cons, SWOT map, Goal breakdown, Weekly review, Study topic, Book notes and Meeting, each drawn in its own shape; the new map's central topic is its name, laid out the way the picture shows (a brainstorm round its centre, pros and cons both ways, a fishbone to the left). A new map that is still just its root offers the same templates as pictures, Start from a template; the X hides it for that map.

The board's Format panel

A board, Ctrl+Shift+P or the selection's More menu

Ctrl+Shift+P on a board (or Format panel in the selection's More menu, or View) opens the Format panel on the right, with three tabs. Style: line colour, width and pattern, fill, opacity, shadow, and for a connector its line shape (curved, straight or elbow), its line jumps (where it crosses a line under it, it hops over with an arc, a gap or a sharp peak), its two ends (twenty-one marks, from the Tessellate end, the mark's node dot ahead of a chevron, through open, filled, stealth, half and double arrows, circles and diamonds to a cross, a bar and a crow's foot, each drawn in its list, each small, medium or large in the menu beside it; a plain line takes them too) and where its label sits along it. Text: the size, colour, weight, alignment and vertical place (top, middle, bottom) of a text box or a shape's words. Arrange: X, Y, width, height and angle as numbers, flip, and the order, align, spacing, group and lock buttons. With several items selected it shows what they all share, and a value they differ on reads Mixed. Every change is one undo step, across the whole selection. Reset style (the item's right-click menu, its ... menu or Ctrl+K) puts colour, fill, line and text back to the defaults, its words, place and ends kept. Colours are in Fill, border and recent colours. Bends, connection points and imports are in Connector bends and importing.

Connector bends, connection points and importing diagrams

A board, Insert, Mermaid, draw.io or board SVG

Connector bends and importing. Every connector takes bends: drag the small ring in the middle of a run (or double-click the line) to add one, drag a bend to move it, double-click it to take it out. A straight line runs through its bends, a curved one curves smoothly through them, and an elbow turns at right angles and goes round the shapes it joins; changing the line shape keeps the bends; moving both things a connector joins moves its bends too. With Select, pointing at a shape, card or text box shows its connection points (a diamond's tips and side middles, an ellipse's compass points); drag from one to draw an elbow connector to whatever you let go on, or to a free end. Drag the square on a connector's label to slide it along the line. The ends include the entity-relationship marks (one, zero or one, many, one or many, zero or many). With one shape or text box selected, the four arrows round it (or Alt+Shift and an arrow key) copy it that way and join facing sides with an elbow; a note card's arrows make a new note there instead, joined and ready to type. Insert, Mermaid, draw.io or board SVG brings in a Mermaid flowchart, state, class or sequence diagram, a .drawio file (pages and swimlanes as frames) or an SVG a board here exported, as shapes and connectors; Export writes an Outline and a Mermaid flowchart.

Mind maps

Library tab, Boards & maps

Mind maps live in the Library, under Boards & maps; New, then Mind map, opens Untitled map N with its central topic ready to type over (what you type names the map too). A note's ⋮ menu, Make a mind map, builds one from that note: its title in the centre, its headings and lists as branches. Tab adds a child, Enter a sibling, and dragging a topic onto another moves its whole branch (onto Drop here to delete, at the foot, deletes the topic and its branch). Right-click a topic for the ring of actions, where Cross-link joins any two topics. View, How this map looks sets its branch colours (eight palettes, classic first), its font, its spacing (Compact, Normal or Roomy) and the look every topic follows unless it was given its own; a topic's pickers can still pull it back to the app's own default. A topic's Add, From the library... points a new topic at a note, document, file or bookmark: a tab for each with its count (the arrows move between them; it opens on the one you used last), type to narrow the list, Down and Enter to choose. A map template (Library, Templates) dropped on a map with no central topic gets one: a template with several top-level topics goes under a new central topic named after it, and one with a single top-level topic makes that topic the centre.

Mind map keys and controls

Library tab, Boards & maps

Mind map keys (a map lives in the Library under Boards and maps). With a topic selected: Tab adds a child, Enter adds a topic right after it and Shift+Enter right before it (what you type next is the new topic's words), Ctrl+D copies it as the next sibling, Ctrl+Shift and the arrows move it among its siblings, Shift+Tab outdents it, the arrow keys walk the tree, F2 or double-click renames (while typing, Enter breaks the line, Esc keeps the name, Tab or Ctrl+Enter adds the next topic, / and [[add links), Delete removes the topic and everything under it, C folds or unfolds its branch (or click the chevron), Alt+1 to Alt+9 show that many levels of the whole map (Alt+1: the trunks alone), Shift+C draws a cross-link to another topic, F shows only this branch and its neighbours (F again: all), Shift+F10 opens every action. Ctrl+Z undoes (100 steps, kept across a reload; a deleted branch comes back whole), Ctrl+Shift+Z redoes. Right-click a topic for the ring: Add child, Add beside, Fold, Delete, Cross-link and More; hold Alt on the ring to remove instead of add. Dragging a topic onto another moves its whole branch; double-click a line to label it. A selected topic has its bar above it: the colour, the text size (minus and plus round the size it reads, S to XL), and Text, Shape and Branch line, each a panel of rows: a small preview of each look you press once, and a reset arrow that puts the topic back to following the map. Drag the square on its bottom right corner to resize it; hold Shift as you drag to scale its text with it. Pick several topics (drag a box round them, or Shift-click) and the bar and the right-click menu act on all of them: colour, bold, tasks, fold, and a summary when they share a parent. A topic's menu has Summarise this branch: a few sentences about everything under it go into the topic's note, yours to change or keep.

Mind map features

Library tab, Boards & maps

Mind map features. The layout picker: tree, radial, logic chart, timeline, fishbone, tree table or free; Tidy lays every unpinned topic out again. The View menu sets Colour by (branch, category, age, or whether a note is behind it) and opens every folded branch; View, Present branches shows it branch by branch. A topic's menu, Content, Markers sets a priority (1 to 5), how far along it is, a flag, a due day and up to six icons; View, Filter by marker dims every topic without the one you pick. The sidebar's Outline tab (View, Outline) lists the map as an indented outline: F2 renames, Shift+Enter adds a topic, Tab and Shift+Tab move it in and out a level. A topic's menu makes it a task: press its box to tick it, and every topic above counts the done ones (1/2); Markdown exports write tasks as - [ ] and - [x]. View, Number the branches numbers every topic by its place (1, 1.1, 1.2), and the Markdown and OPML exports keep the numbers. A topic's menu adds a note behind it: its mark on the topic opens it. Comment... starts a thread, counted on its corner; its Branch group draws a boundary round the branch or summarises topics side by side. Templates, import and export are in Mind map import and export.

Mind map templates, import and export

Library tab, Boards & maps

Mind map import and export. Start from a template, import an OPML, FreeMind, XMind, Markdown or text outline (it opens as a tree), paste an indented list onto a topic to add it as that topic's branch, let the local AI propose a map from notes you pick, or on a topic choose Add, Branches from my notes... for up to five children found in your notes, each saying which note it came from; export it as OPML, FreeMind, XMind, Markdown or text as well as a picture, or write it as a document (the board menu's Write as a document: branches become headings, deeper topics lists, notes paragraphs); a document's menu, Map the headings, goes the other way. With a map open, the command palette (Ctrl+K) lists the map's commands: add, rename, fold, focus, tidy, layout, look, numbering, present and export.

Study the map

Library tab, Boards & maps, a map's board menu

Study the map. On a mind map, the board menu's Study the map goes full screen and asks one branch at a time: what is under it is hidden until you press Show (or Enter), then Knew it or Not yet marks it and moves on. Only branches with topics under them are asked. Nothing on the map changes. Your marks are kept for that map on this device, a branch you missed says so next time, and the end says how many you recalled. Esc stops.

How a map's topics look

Library tab, Boards & maps, a map

How a map's topics look. A map draws as a hierarchy: the centre large, bold and filled, each main branch bold on a tinted card with a thick line, deeper topics plain. Enter on the centre adds a main branch. A topic's own size, shape or fill always beats its level's: the Text and Shape menus over a selected topic set them, and Fill offers Solid colour. View, How this map looks picks the hierarchy (Classic, Outline with plain text on the lines, Boxed, or Flat for every topic alike) and, with Setting on The centre, Main branches or Sub-topics, that level's size, weight, box, edge bar, fill, line and effect. A topic's Effect, in its Shape group: a soft shadow, or a glow in its branch colour (No effect keeps one plain on a level that has one). A topic's menu, Look: Copy this topic's style and Paste style (Ctrl+Alt+C and V, onto every selected topic), and Use this look for its level, which hands the topic's own look to every topic at its level. Each is one Undo step. A topic's icon: the Text menu's Icon row has eleven, and More icons and emoji... opens every Phosphor icon and about 470 emoji, searchable, with your recent ones first; an emoji or an icon, one per topic.

Emoji and icons

The smiley on a board's or map's tool dock, or its Insert menu; a topic's Text menu

Emoji and icons. One picker holds every Phosphor icon the app ships and about 470 emoji: Emoji or Icons in the tab strip under its title, type to search, Recent first, arrows and Enter to choose, Escape to close. On a board or a map, the smiley on the tool dock (Add on a board, Map on a map) or Insert, Emoji and icons... keeps it open: press one to place it in the middle of the view, or drag it where it goes. An emoji lands as a sticker (no card, resize it like any item), an icon as a shape you can recolour; dropped on a map topic, either becomes that topic's icon. Each is one Undo step. In a note or a document, the smiley in the formatting toolbar (the document's Insert menu) or Emoji or icon in the / menu puts one at the caret: an emoji as itself, an icon as :ph-name:, which reading shows as the icon.

Comments on boards and maps

An item's right-click menu, Comment...

Comments on a board or a map. Right-click a card, sticky, shape or topic and choose Comment... for a thread on it; the count on its corner opens it again. Each comment has Reply (answered one step in under it), Edit (in place: Enter keeps it, Esc puts it back, and the row then says edited), Resolve (folded under N resolved; the corner counts only what is open, and shows a tick once nothing is) and Delete (with its replies). In the box, Attach adds a bookmark, note, document or board, / offers links, a bookmark, an emoji or the date, and [[links a note. A link alone on its line shows as a link card. Enter posts, Shift+Enter breaks the line, and Ctrl+Z takes back any change. Threads are not exported.

Sticky notes and text boxes

A board's tool dock, Add

Sticky notes and text boxes on a board. A sticky (N, or the note on the tool dock) is paper: its colour, a lift, and a folded corner. A text box (T) is words on the board, with no fill and a faint dashed edge. Select a sticky and its bar starts with seven papers (yellow, orange, pink, purple, blue, green, grey); any other colour, and a text box's own fill or edge, are under the bar's ... menu, Box. The folded corner can be switched off for one note (Format panel, Folded corner) or as the board's default (View, Folded sticky corners). Each change is one Undo step. Typing in either, / offers lists, a to-do, headings, links and an emoji, and [[links a note.

A structure per branch

A map topic's menu, Structure

A branch can have its own structure, as in XMind: a topic's menu, Structure, lays the branch under it out as a logic chart, an org chart, a tree table, a timeline, a fishbone, both sides, a tree to the right or left, or radial, while the rest of the map keeps its layout. The branch is laid out as one block, so nothing else overlaps it; Follow the map's layout takes it back. Ctrl+Z undoes it in one step.

Callouts, labels and stamps on a topic

A map topic's menu, Topic

A callout is a few words in a bubble over a topic, as in XMind: a topic's menu, Topic, Add a callout... writes it; double-click the bubble to change it, or Remove the callout in the same menu. Add labels... in the same group writes up to eight short tags, separated by commas, drawn as a row under the topic's words; double-click the row to change them. Stamps, in the topic's menu, adds a vote, a heart, a star, an agree, a question or a hot, each with its count after the labels; press a stamp on the topic to add one more, and Clear the stamps takes them off. The map makes room for all three when it is laid out, and the exports keep them.

The current layer

A board's sidebar, Layers

The current layer, as in draw.io: in a board's sidebar, Layers, press a named layer's name and everything new (drawn, typed, pasted, imported or placed from the library) goes on it; the row is tinted while it is current. Press the name again, or its ⋯ menu's Stop drawing on it, for no layer. A hidden or locked layer takes nothing new. Undo brings a deleted item back on the layer it was on.

The hand-drawn look

A board's View menu, Hand-drawn look

The hand-drawn look, as in Excalidraw: a board's View menu, Hand-drawn look, draws every shape and connector with rough strokes, the same each time it is drawn. One shape can differ: its Format panel's Style tab has Hand-drawn. The pen and the highlighter are drawn as you drew them, and a mind map keeps its own lines. Exports keep the look.

Tables on a board

A board's Insert menu, Table

A table on a board, as in draw.io: Insert, Table places three rows of three cells, the first a header. Double-click a cell to type in it; Tab and Shift+Tab go to the next and previous cell, Enter keeps the words, Escape drops them. Right-click the table for Add a row below or above, Add a column to the right or left, Delete this row or column (at the cell you pressed last) and First row as a header. Resize it by its handles; every cell keeps an equal share.

Edit data on a board item

A board's Format panel, Data

Edit data, as in draw.io: select one shape, line, connector, text box, picture, frame or table and open the Format panel's Data tab (or Edit data in the command palette). Add a property gives a name and a value; a name starts with a letter. Changes save as you leave a field, each one Undo step, and the values stay with the item.

Fill, border and recent colours on a board

A shape's bar, Fill or Border

Colours on a board: every colour button (a shape's Fill and Border on its bar and in the Format panel, text, and the draw colour) opens one menu. For a shape it names both, Fill and Border, with a dot of each: press the other to set it instead. Same as fill (or Same as border) makes them one colour and Swap trades them, each one Undo step. Recent holds your last eight picks on this device, above the board's colours; More colours opens any colour by number. Pick from the board is the eyedropper: the next click takes a colour instead of doing what it would, from a shape (its fill, or its border with Alt or Take a shape's border), a line, a text box or any colour button, and Escape stops it. A fill that is off shows dimmed; picking a colour turns it on.

Library and files

The Library

Library tab

The Library is everything already made, in one searchable, filterable place: notes, documents, chats, files and tags, plus Bookmarks (a shelf for websites you visit often), Contents (a hyperlinked outline of the whole notebook) and AI skills. The other sub-tabs are Documents, Boards & maps (whiteboards and mind maps), Images and Files. Each sub-tab's top bar ends with a ? that says what it holds. The Highlights chip lists every passage you marked in a note, each with its note. The Activity chip lists everything you and Atlas did, and its Export activity button saves that log as a spreadsheet (when, who, what, which item) to hand over. Events about private notes are left out of it. The Library's search reads the same filters as the Graph's: "connected to Harbor", "untouched since June", "tagged work", "pinned", "filed under Cooking". Drop files anywhere in the app to add them: pictures and PDFs go to Images, anything else becomes a document.

Library controls

Library tab

Library controls. The sub-tabs are plain words with a line under the one you are on (Notes and the document sidebar draw theirs the same way): All (everything you have made), Documents, Boards & maps, Images, Files, AI skills, Bookmarks and Contents. Search, then sort newest first, oldest first, A to Z or biggest first, and set how many show per page. Tick a card's box to select it: the bar that appears has Select all, Open, Restore (for binned items), Delete and Done, and Documents and the gallery have bars of their own. New (a whiteboard or a mind map), Map from notes and Import outline sit on Boards & maps; Images takes uploads of pictures and PDFs.

Bookmarks

Library tab, Bookmarks

Library, Bookmarks is a reading list of web links; Add bookmark saves one. Unread and Pinned narrow the list (with counts), and opening a link marks it read. Sort by newest, oldest, title or By site, which groups links under their site in folds you can close. Each link shows its kind, Details opens in place with a note field, and selecting several offers Move to group, Mark read and Pin; pinned links lead every order but By site, and every delete has Undo. In a note or document, the / menu's Bookmark link inserts a saved bookmark as a link.

Clip a page from your browser

Settings, Import & export, Web clipper

Settings, Import & export, Web clipper has a bookmark called Clip to Tessellate. Drag it to your browser's bookmarks bar (or press Copy the bookmark and make a bookmark with it as the address). On any page, press it: a small Tessellate window opens beside the page with its title and address, and Save as a note keeps the page's main text, or only the text you had selected. Your own browser sends the page, so nothing is fetched from the web: it works with web search off and on pages you signed in to see. No browser extension is needed. A clipped note keeps its address, Atlas treats its text as someone else's words and never follows instructions in it, and clipping the same page again points you to the note it made the first time.

Contents, the notebook's outline

Library tab, Contents

Library, Contents is the whole notebook as a tree: pick By category, By tag, By topic, By month or By folder in its Group by list, and each group folds at its heading. A document lists its headings, so a press jumps straight to one. Expand all and Collapse all, in the ⋯ menu, open or fold every group; folded, the groups are a list of places to go. From the keyboard the Up and Down arrows move, Right opens a row, Left folds it, Home and End jump to the ends, and Enter opens. By month puts each document under the month it was made, with that month's notes. By topic groups notes by the subjects the graph finds in how they link; F2 or right-click on a topic's heading renames it or shows it on the graph.

AI skills in the Library

Library tab, AI skills

Library, AI skills lists every skill: the filter beside the search shows All skills, Yours or Built-in (your own or the ones that ship with the app, each with its count), and the sort button (the arrows beside them) orders by Yours first, Name A to Z or Recently run. Each card says whether the skill Reads only or Changes notes, and how its last run went. Duplicate makes a copy of any skill, a built-in one included, to edit as your own; Delete has Undo. Settings, Skills is where a skill is written and edited. In Chat, a run's What changed list has an Undo on each change, and Undo the run puts back every note it changed at once, after showing what will go back (a board item cannot be undone, and the list says so).

Pictures, scans and PDFs

Library tab, Images and Files

Every image is read automatically, up to three ways: an AI caption of what it shows, a vision-model transcription of any text in it, and Tesseract OCR (or RapidOCR) if that's installed: all editable and searchable. A scanned PDF is rasterised page-by-page and read by an OCR model (no Tesseract needed); you can pick the model or leave it automatic.

The OCR workspace

Read text, on any image or PDF

OCR workspace: open any image or PDF from the Library or a note and choose "Read text", or open it from Commands, Find anything or Quick access (search ocr). A pinch, two fingers on a touch screen or Ctrl and the wheel zooms the page about the pointer. Where Tesseract or RapidOCR read it, drag across the words on the page to select them; Ctrl+C copies them in reading order. Find in what was read marks every match, and Enter or its arrows step through them. Saving an edit, deleting, cleaning up and reading again all undo with Ctrl+Z, and a deleted reading goes to the bin. The reader button in the tool row (its dot is green when it can read) picks the AI document reader (a model built to transcribe a page), the general vision model where you have a different one installed, Tesseract, or RapidOCR (English and Chinese, nothing else to install; chosen, it reads even when Tesseract is ready). The two local ones need no model, are about ten times faster and are the only readers that tell you where on the page each block sits; the workspace remembers your choice. Read this page reads what is on screen; its menu reads every page or a range like 1-5. Ask sends the page to the chat as a chip on your next message. A read keeps running if you close the window: it shows in Settings, Background tasks and can be stopped from there or from the workspace, and every page that has been read is remembered, so reopening the document shows the text again rather than starting over.

Tesseract and the reading language

The OCR workspace, the reader button

In the OCR workspace, the reader button's dot says whether Tesseract can read (green) or not (amber); its menu shows the version and the language it reads in. Pick the language there, and every read follows it, the background pass included. When Tesseract cannot read, the menu names the cause and offers Install, with its progress, and the tool row's ... menu opens Settings to manage it; a read it cannot do falls to the vision model, and each reading names the engine that read it. Read again reads afresh, and a reading can be edited by hand or added to an existing note. Settings, Packages shows the same status and language. RapidOCR, a second reader with nothing else to install (its own row in Settings, Packages), can be chosen in the reader button's menu, and then reads even when Tesseract is ready; with nothing chosen it reads when Tesseract isn't ready. Its models read English and Chinese, so the language does not apply. Not installed, the menu says so and its Install opens that Packages row. With no engine and no model the menu offers RapidOCR first (about 60 MB, nothing else to install), then Tesseract, each with its own Install, and Read says why it cannot read yet. The workspace remembers the reader you chose.

Archiving

Each item's own menu, and the Library's Archived filter

Archiving keeps a note, chat or document but gets it out of your everyday lists: different from the bin, since nothing archived is ever auto-cleared or at risk of being deleted. The action is in each item's own menu (next to Delete, not grouped with it); everything archived is still reachable from the Library's Archived filter, where Unarchive brings it straight back.

Undo and the bin

the bin: the Library's Include the bin, or Ctrl+Z right after

Undo and Redo cover everything you change in your notebook. A deleted note, board, document, reminder or OCR reading goes to the bin, not gone for good: restore it from the Library (Filter, Include the bin, or Open the bin from Ctrl+K), or press Undo in the toast right after, which also has a Go to bin button for a note. A deleted picture or file, a past question, what the notebook learned (even Forget everything), a board library and a space are kept for two weeks, so Undo brings them back. Ctrl/Cmd+Z undoes and Ctrl+Shift+Z or Ctrl+Y redoes; the status bar's Undo and Redo buttons do the same by click, and every step has a working Redo. Which history they walk depends on where you are: an open board or mind map has its own, an open document has its own, and both are kept while you switch away and back; everywhere else it is the app's (notes, tags, categories, links, files, bookmarks, renames, settings, chats, pins and the rest). Four things have no Undo, on purpose: Delete for good and Empty bin, which ask first; sending a chat message (the chat keeps its own history); asking the model something (it changes nothing until you accept); and sign-in, lock and background work. Inside a text box Ctrl+Z undoes your typing.

Graph, Timeline, Reminders and Dashboard

The graph

Graph tab

The Graph tab shows notes as a force-directed map, links and threads drawn between them, plus optional AI similarity lines. Search highlights matches, dragging rearranges, and the legend toggles categories on and off. Mind maps (drawn by you, not the automatic graph) are made and managed from the Library. A mind map's topics are notes, kept out of Notes and Recently added; a search finds them. After Enter names a topic, typing renames it. The Graph's search box reads filters as well as words: "connected to Harbor", "untouched since June", "tagged work", "pinned", "with pictures", "edited last week"; any other words still have to match.

Graph keys and controls

Graph tab

Graph keys and controls. Click the map, then the arrow keys move between notes, N steps to the next connected note, Enter or Space opens one, + and - zoom, 0 fits the whole map, Shift and the arrows pan, Esc leaves. Drag a note to move it (it settles near the drop); double-click it to pin it, again to free it. Drop one note onto another to link them, double-click empty space to add a note there, hover to spotlight a note's connections, point at a line to light it and click it to see what it is, its reason and how sure, the two notes, and for a link Edit reason, Two-way (no arrow) and Remove, and click a legend colour to hide that category. Shift and drag on empty map lassos notes, and the selection bar can Tag, Link together, Unlink (both undoable with Ctrl+Z) or make a Mind map of them, built from their links round the picked or most connected note, with Open on the notice that follows. Display options, the gear, opens with View: Layout (Force, Tree, Radial or Arc; the dock names a fixed one), Shape (Organic, Clusters or Galaxy; the Force layout's own, dimmed under the others), Colour, Size, Trace, which finds how two notes connect, and Legend, which hides the key. Then Physics (Unpin all, Reshuffle layout, Gravity, Spread, Link force, Length by similarity, Group by category), the Show switches (Similarity, Entities, Documents, Boards, Tags, Attachments, Unwritten links, Hide unlinked), Display (Labels, Label backgrounds, Curved links, Cluster glow, Arrows), the similarity Strength slider (raise it to keep only the closest matches), a Time filter you can play, Groups that paint notes matching some words one colour, the minimap's position and size, and Reset, which puts the layout, colours, physics, switches, time filter and minimap back and keeps groups and saved views. Saved views keep the layout, filters and position under a name.

More graph controls

Graph tab, the gear

More graph controls, in the gear. Show adds Tags (a node per tag), Attachments (a node per file or picture) and Unwritten links: each [[name]] no note answers to is a faint node, and clicking it writes that note, named in its heading, linked from every note that named it. Display holds Labels, Label backgrounds (off draws names on a thin outline), Curved links, Cluster glow, Arrows (off at first: a spark on each link, its tail toward the note that made it, the line wider at that end; pointing at a note sends a spark along its links unless motion is reduced), Text fade (how far out names stay on a big map) and Link thickness. Physics adds Link force, Length by similarity and Group by category. In focus mode a Focus section sets Depth (1 to 5 links) and Incoming, Outgoing and Neighbour links; the Local map beside a note has the same four under Options. Colour: Topic outlines each subject inside a cluster, names it by the tag, person or word its notes share most, and its legend entry finds those notes and opens its card, where Summarise asks your local model for one sentence (with no model, what they share), File as a category files its notes under one category, and the pencil renames it (the arrow brings the found name back). On the map, drag a topic's name to move all its notes together (they stay put; Unpin all releases them), double-click it to rename, click it for its card. A note's card and its panel show its topic; pressing it opens the graph on that topic. No note's name is drawn over a topic's name. Filter holds a chip per kind of link on the map (press one to take those links off, again to bring them back) and per property value (press to light those notes). Colour: Note type paints each note its type's colour (Person, Project, Meeting, Book and Place come built in). In Trace, a step marked +2 has two more reasons its notes relate; point at it to read them.

People and things

Graph tab, an entity; or the command palette, People and things

Atlas notes the people, places, projects, organisations and things your notes name, with a kind for each. Show, Entities on the Graph draws them; two named together in two notes or more are joined. Click one, or open People and things from the command palette, for its page: every note that names it with the sentence, what it is named with, and the dates its notes mention. Its ⋯ sets the Kind, Renames it, edits Other names (the names it also goes by) and Merges it into another, moving every mention; Undo in the toast, or Ctrl+Z, splits the two back as they were. Suggestions, Names offers the merges that look right ("Sam" and "Sam Lee").

Note properties and types

a note's ⋯, Properties; or the command palette, Note types

A note can carry properties (status: open, owner: Priya), kept at the top of its own text between two --- lines, the way Obsidian writes them, so an imported vault keeps them and an export carries them. They show as a small table under the note's title, where pressing a value finds every note with it; a note's panel on the graph shows them too, a value lighting those notes on the map, with a Properties button. A note's ⋯ has Properties: add, change or remove one, or pick a Type, and Save rewrites only those lines. Note types in the command palette makes a kind of note (Meeting: attendees, date) with fields that are text, a number, a date, a list, yes/no or another note (the magnifier beside a note field searches your notes for it); its New note starts with them. A document's properties panel does the same: with type: Meeting in its properties, the type's fields it has not written yet show as empty rows, and a value you enter is written as one line. The notes filter asks about them: type:meeting, prop:status=open (a value with a space in quotes: prop:status="in progress") (or prop:effort>2), links:[[Kiln plan]], rel:supports, entity:"Sam Lee", with - before any of them to leave those out; a bar over the list then shows the same notes as a Table, with their properties as columns, or lit on the graph. The table's last row rolls each column up over every match: Count, and Sum, Min and Max for numbers, Earliest and Latest for dates. On the graph, View, Colour, Note type paints each note by its type; a type's ⋮ in Note types has Colour to choose which.

The Timeline

Timeline tab

The Timeline tab lists what you wrote newest first, grouped by day, week, month or year (Auto picks the finest that reads well), as a feed, as a sortable table or as a calendar of a month, a week or a day. Kinds chooses notes, boards and maps, documents and reminders; Options sets the grouping, Group by (category, tag or thread) and Show group, and the Time range, where On this day shows today's date in earlier months and years. In the feed, Ctrl and the mouse wheel, or a pinch, makes the date groups finer or coarser, as do + and - on a row. The strip under the bar walks your daily pages, and the chip under it offers On this day, and the year menu beside the month narrows the list to one year. A note that names a day ("on Friday") sits on that day and says All day; one that names a time too ("on Friday at 3pm") shows that time.

Timeline controls

Timeline tab

Timeline controls. Feed shows the newest first, grouped by date; Table shows every column, sortable; Calendar shows a month, a week (hour rows) or a day: reminders and meetings at their time, a day's page at the top of its day and a chip with its title for each note (a dot each where a day is too short). Press a day to open it as a Day view; a +n opens the day in the feed. Drag a reminder to another day or hour to move it, or press Alt and an arrow on it (Undo puts it back); the arrows walk the days, Page Up and Page Down the months, T is today, Enter or Space opens the day (from a Day view, in the feed) and N starts a reminder on it. Below a tablet's width the calendar is the month's rows as a list. Pick the time bucket (Auto, Day, Week, Month or Year; Auto takes the finest one that keeps the headers few and filled: days for a few weeks of notes, weeks for a year, months for several years), what rows are grouped by (Category, Tag, Thread, None or Everything) and show only one group, how far back (the last 3 months, the last year, everything or a custom range), and which kinds of thing it shows; Jump to today returns. A note that names a date ("the deadline is next Friday", "2026-10-25") sits on that day, marked with a clock; a second date shows an arrow chip in the calendar. The arrow keys walk the rows, Home and End jump to the ends, Enter opens a row where it sits and Esc closes it; in Select mode Space ticks a row, and the bar moves, tags or deletes them. The density strip beside the feed shows how much was written when: click or drag it to go there. Above the feed, the calendar strip shows the last seven days with a dot under each day that has a page: press a day to open its page or start it (the arrows beside the month move a week, the month opens a calendar to jump to any earlier day).

Reminders

Reminders tab

The Reminders tab groups items into Overdue / Today / Upcoming / Done. Set a priority, snooze, edit inline, or make one recurring: "every weekday", "every 2 weeks", "the last Friday of the month", with an early alert such as "1 day before". The date and time fields open a month and the day's times, and read a typed day such as "next friday". You can also just say "call mum tomorrow evening" in a note and let the AI schedule it. In the chat, "remind me two hours before midnight" works too: Atlas passes your words and the app works out the time on your own clock. Notifications fire on the minute while a tab is open, even in the background, with Done and Snooze on them; the desktop app notifies with its window closed. If the browser blocks them, the list and the Notifications group in Settings say so, and their ? says how to allow them. Remind me is on a note's, a document's and a board's ⋯ menu too, and the reminder's row opens what it is about.

Reminders controls

Reminders tab

Reminders controls. Magic add takes a sentence ("Call mum tomorrow evening, high priority"), then Enter or the sparkle button (Add from this sentence) works out the time and the priority. Times like "tomorrow at 5pm", "next Friday", "tonight", "in 20 minutes" or "every Tuesday" (saved as a weekly repeat) are read with no AI and shown as chips under the box before Enter (press one to leave it as words); with no day or time it asks for one rather than guessing, and the AI is asked only for a phrasing those rules miss. Or type the reminder, pick a priority (normal, low or high) and a repeat (once, daily, weekly or monthly), and use Quick set: in 30 min, in 1 hour, in 3 hours, tonight 7pm, tomorrow 9am, tomorrow 2pm, this weekend or next week. A due reminder can be snoozed one hour or to tomorrow 9am (ten minutes is on its menu; Undo in the toast puts the time back), edited in place (its early alert too), or ticked done; completed ones page at the foot. Add to calendar (.ics), on a reminder's menu, saves it as a calendar file, and Add all to calendar (.ics) in the More menu saves every upcoming one; Import a calendar (.ics) there reads a calendar file as reminders and names any event it skipped. Calendar beside List opens the Timeline's calendar with only reminders, where one drags to another day. Press m then r to jump here from anywhere.

The dashboard

Dashboard tab

The Dashboard is the at-a-glance home: a greeting with your note count, what is due and a pattern your notes show (a subject you keep writing about, a busy week; Tidy lists them), a search box, the Quick access tiles, and widgets such as reminders, recent notes, the Digest (your day with no AI: what is due, open questions, what changed since yesterday and topics gone quiet, each line a count or a quote that opens its note; Atlas writes the week on request), stats, your streak, Most opened this month and Filings to check. Customise, beside the search box, has Edit layout and Widgets to show, hide and rearrange them; the layout is remembered per user.

Dashboard controls

Dashboard tab

Dashboard controls. Under the greeting is the search box (Ctrl+P), then Customise and a ... menu. The ... menu is for doing: Continue (the note you opened or edited last), your two most recent skills and All skills, Tools & features (a searchable list of everything the app can do) and Commands (the command palette). Customise arranges the page: View (Full, Compact or Focused), Widgets and Edit layout, which show, hide and rearrange widgets. The Focused view folds Quick access away and its greeting card holds New note and four tiles for today: what is due today, today's meetings, the notes to file and the note you were last in; press one to go there. Customise, and the ... at the right of the Quick access title, have Edit quick access: Add or arrange opens a list of every command with the ones on your dashboard checked and first. Check or uncheck as many as you like (up to eight), drag a row or press Alt with Up or Down to reorder, search to narrow it, then Done saves them all at once; a tile's menu still has Move left, Move right, Highlight and Remove. The first tile is highlighted in the accent; Highlight gives any tile the accent, one of twelve colours or No highlight. Reset highlights clears the colours (the first tile is highlighted again); Reset quick access goes back to the defaults. Quick access starts as New note, Ask AI, Sketch, Remind me and New meeting. All of it is remembered per user. Press m then d to come back here from anywhere.

Notifications

The bell in the top bar

The bell in the top bar collects what happened while you were busy: reminders coming due, background jobs that finished, and Atlas's suggestions. The number on it is what you have not seen. A pop-up with a button (Undo, Open it, Show it) is kept here with the same button: an opener still works after a restart, an Undo only while it can still be undone, then its line says Undo expired. Each row has two controls at its right edge: the circle marks it read or unread, the cross removes just that one; the bin at the bottom clears them all. Reminders also pop up on their own while a tab or the desktop app is open.

Spaces

The picker at the top of the sidebar

A space is a separate notebook inside the same app: notes, documents, chats and tags kept apart from other spaces. Switch or create one from the picker at the top of the sidebar; "All spaces" shows everything together. Deleting a space asks what happens to its contents: delete everything in it, or move everything to another space (a category both have is merged).

Statistics

Dashboard, Activity heatmap, Statistics

Statistics counts your notebook with no model: notes, words, tags, categories, documents, links and notes with no link, a chart of notes made per month over the last year, reminders made, done, open and late, and what you use on this computer (features used, uses counted, and the ones not used lately). This week compares notes made, words written and reminders done since Monday with the whole of last week. Open it from the Statistics button under the Dashboard's Activity heatmap (or a click on the heatmap), the This week card's All statistics, or Statistics in the command palette (Ctrl+K). Private and binned notes are not counted.

Small tools

Timer and stopwatch

Command palette, timer

Type timer in the command palette (Ctrl+K; its ? at the foot lists the timer, the stopwatch and Count words) for Start a timer (25 minutes) and Start a stopwatch, or type a length, such as timer 10 minutes, 90s timer or countdown 2h, and press Enter. The time runs on the status bar (on a phone the bar comes back while it runs); press that timer chip in the status bar to stop it. When a timer runs out it says so in a message and a notification. The Dashboard's Focus timer widget is a separate timer: a ring with the time, lengths of 5, 15, 25 or 50 minutes (or minus and plus for any other), one Start that becomes Pause, a chime and a notification at the end, Breaks for a five-minute break after each session, and the minutes focused today.

Count words

Command palette, Count words

Select text in any editor (a note, the Capture box, a document) and run Count words from the command palette (Ctrl+K): it says the words, the characters with and without spaces, and the reading time, counted the way wc counts. With nothing selected it counts the whole editor you were in. The Capture box and a document also show a running count as you type.

Insert a template

Command palette, insert template

Type insert template (or template and part of its name) in the command palette (Ctrl+K) to list your templates; Enter puts the one you choose where your cursor was, in any editor, with {date}, {{time}} and {{clipboard}} filled in. With no editor open it goes into the Capture box. The templates, yours and the built-in ones, are in Settings, Templates, where you write, edit and reset them.

Look and feel

Appearance

Settings, Appearance

Settings, Appearance controls theme (light/dark/system), accent colour, fonts, density, glass effects and the animated background. High-contrast and reduce-motion options are there for comfort and accessibility: Reduce motion stills Atlas, the background art, the graph and the whiteboard, and Interface animations (on by default) keeps the short fades and slides of menus, dialogs and tabs and a button's press even then; turn it off and they are instant. Font and Density (Typography & layout) are lists you pick from. Font's Readable is Atkinson Hyperlegible, a face drawn so that letters easily mistaken for each other (l, I and 1; O and 0) look different; it ships with the app and works offline. Density's Auto, the default, is Compact on a window 700px tall or less and the look's own spacing on a taller one. Performance mode (Effects & accessibility) turns off the frosted-glass blur, the large animations and the animated background and slows the graph physics, for a slow or small machine; Auto switches it on by itself on a machine with 2 cores or 4 GB or fewer, and On or Off overrides that.

Themes, colour and type

Settings, Appearance

Settings, Appearance. Themes: hover a theme to see it on the whole app, press Surprise me for a random one, save and switch your own. Theme & colour: Palette, Mode (light, dark or system), Accent colour or a custom one (a colour a button's words cannot be read on is offered at the nearest shade that can), Page background, and Build a scheme from one colour. Typography & layout: Text size, Font (System, Serif, Mono, Arial, or Readable, the Atkinson Hyperlegible face), Density, Corner rounding, Zoom, Border style and Shadow intensity (Text size, Density and Zoom are marked On this device: a phone and a computer each keep their own, while colours and fonts follow you). Effects & accessibility: Performance mode, the glass's sheen, blur and opacity, Progress indicators, Reduce motion (stills Atlas, the background art, the graph and the whiteboard) and Interface animations (on by default: a button's press, menus and dialogs opening, a tab's sliding marker, even with Reduce motion on; off makes them instant). Advanced has Custom CSS. Ctrl+Shift+L switches light and dark from anywhere.

Simple mode

Settings, General, Simple mode

Settings, General, Simple mode: Show only Dashboard, Notes, Chat and Library. It hides the Graph, Timeline and Reminders tabs, the Library's Boards & maps, What it learned and the advanced response settings until you want them. Nothing is turned off: every hidden place still opens from the command palette (Ctrl+K), and reminders still ring. It is remembered on this device; turn it off in the same place to bring the tabs back.

Accessibility and zoom

Settings, Keyboard shortcuts and Appearance

Accessibility. The app works at 200% and 400% browser zoom: on a short window Chat flows as a page, and sub-tab strips scroll with the page so a focused control stays in view. Settings, Keyboard shortcuts has Single-key shortcuts: turn it off so speech input or a stray key cannot set off m, / or ? and the other keys with no Ctrl or Alt. A toast steps aside, fading and letting clicks through, while the focused control is under it. For a screen reader every tab has one main landmark, editors and panels have names, and resize grips say how wide a panel is. Settings, Appearance has High contrast, Reduce motion, Interface animations, Text size and Zoom.

When the app feels slow

Settings, Appearance

If the app feels slow, turn on Performance mode in Settings, Appearance: it switches off the glass, the background art and most animation. The built-in search engine uses about 650 MB of memory while the app is open; choosing Ollama's nomic-embed-text for embeddings in Settings, Search and index keeps Tessellate itself near 100 MB.

The animated background

Settings, Appearance, Animated background

Settings, Appearance, Animated background: Style is a card per art, lightest first, each with a preview and its cost, Light, Medium or Heavy, from what one frame takes; picking a card turns the background on. Movement sets how much it moves and Intensity how strong it is. Page background in Theme & colour sets the colour under it. Performance mode and Battery-efficient mode both stop it, and so does Reduce motion.

The status bar

Settings, Appearance, Status bar

The status bar is the strip along the bottom of every screen. It shows what the local model is doing (a grey sparkle with a slash means no model is connected and the notebook works without one), your note count, open and due reminders, back and forward (the small arrow beside them, or a right-click on either, lists the places you have been: an icon, the note's or document's title, a thumbnail when a note opens with a picture, and the tab in muted text under it; the X beside a row or Delete takes it off, and Clear this list keeps only where you are), undo and redo, Commands with its Ctrl/Cmd+K hint, and three icons: the agent's mark (crosses, a circle and an arrow, a play drawn up) for the popup agent, the compass for Atlas the guide, and the magnifying glass for Find anything (hover one for its name and keys). On this computer a wifi icon says whether other devices on your network can open the app: green open, amber closed on this network, plain off; press it (or Alt+L) for the switch, the address and the trusted networks. The offline badge, the power-saver badge and the running-job slot appear only when there is something to say. Settings, Appearance, Status bar chooses which of the rest to show.

The corner companion

Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces, Corner companion

The corner companion is a small character that lives on the page, not in any tab: it finds a free spot on each page, perches on a panel or a toolbar and rides with it as the page scrolls, reacts to what you do, and naps when you are away. It steps out of the way of menus, popups and the guided tour. Choose who it is in Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces, Corner companion: Off, You, The chat's persona, Atlas, or Your own character (a name and parts of its own). Companion size is Small, Medium or Large, or drag the handle at its corner (double-click or double-tap the handle for Medium again); the size is marked On this device, so a phone keeps its own. Drag it onto a panel and that page keeps it there on this device; throw it (let go while moving fast) and it flies, bounces off the window's edges and stays where it lands. Move the pointer back and forth over it to rub it and it leans into your hand; shake it up and down while you carry it and it turns upside down, then lands a little dizzy (each has a switch in Appearance, under What it does on its own). When it has something on (headphones while a sound plays, a bell for a reminder, a moon on its ear as it rests), rest the pointer on it and its tooltip says what and why. Its large view (double-click it) has a row of things to ask of it: wave, cheer, hop, stretch, shrug or wiggle, and Atlas also juggles stars, reads its map and meditates. Right-click it, or press Shift+F10 on it, for its menu: Say hello, Enlarge, Stay here on every page, Let it choose its spot here, a size, Call back and reset its place, and Hide. Ctrl+Shift+Y shows or hides it from anywhere, and the command palette and Find anything have Show or hide the companion. If it is ever out of reach, Call back (beside the setting, in its menu or in the command palette) brings it back.

How Atlas looks

Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces, Atlas style and Atlas look

Atlas is drawn as a small character of starlight with rings round its head, or, if you prefer, as the classic glowing globe: Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces, Atlas style. Atlas look picks Masculine or Feminine, or Auto, which follows Face looks when that is set to one look and your own face's look otherwise; it is used everywhere Atlas appears, the dashboard mark and the chat's replies included. Assistant avatar, in the same place, swaps the face on the assistant's chat replies, the popup agent and the guide between Atlas and the app's animated emblem (it holds still under Reduce motion or with Interface animations off); other personas keep their own faces. Atlas's face follows the app's mood: thinking while an answer runs, happy when it lands, worried at an error, sleepy late at night. Enlarge, in the companion's menu or on any face, shows the full drawing; right-click the companion there to change who it is, its look or its size.

Generated faces

Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces

Every person, persona and chat gets a generated face, drawn from its name: a name that says a mood ("sleepy wizard") or an animal gets that face, and any other name still gets a character of its own, the same one every time, and each character wears a mood in its own way. Settings, Appearance, Atlas and faces: Avatar animation (Always, On hover, Off) lets faces blink and act out their mood, Faces follow the pointer turns eyes and heads toward your mouse, Face looks sets hair, brows and jaw (Neutral, Masculine, Feminine; never read from a name), and Dashboard mark swaps the dashboard's logo for a face. Your own face is in Settings, Profile, Your look: Shuffle redraws it, and Choose parts yourself sets any part by hand. Reduce motion stops the animation.

Models and the AI

Models

Settings, Models

Settings, Models picks the chat model and an optional smaller utility model for background jobs. Any OpenAI-compatible server works, not just Ollama, LM Studio, llama-server, Jan, vLLM. Sampling parameters (temperature, top-p, top-k, min-p, repeat penalty) are exposed there too, starting at what the model itself recommends.

Downloading a model

Settings, Models, Suggested downloads

Settings, Models, Suggested downloads: cards grouped by purpose (chat and filing, bigger machines, search, images, reading text), each with its size on disk, the memory it asks for, what it is good at and whether it fits this computer, and one starting pick per group. One button downloads it or puts it to use, with progress and Cancel on the card; Remove and Copy name are in its menu. Hide models too big for this computer leaves out the ones that will not fit. Download another model takes any Ollama model name or a Hugging Face link and says what it is before it downloads. Installed models shows the models you have as the same cards, with their size on this computer and what each is in use for; a card's menu puts it to use, copies its name or removes it (not while it is in use).

Test my models

Settings, Models, Test my models

Settings, Models, Test my models runs your installed models on your own notes and recommends one. Tick the models to compare and press Run the test: each model files a sample of the notes you filed yourself, answers a question about each one from three notes shown to it, and calls a search tool five times. Every row shows Filing, Answers and Tools as a percentage, how long an answer took and how many tokens it used, with the first few things it got wrong, so you can check the recommendation. Use this one makes that model answer in chat. Stop ends a run, and a stopped run makes no recommendation. It needs at least six filed notes, runs entirely on this computer, and can be switched off in Settings, What it learned, What may run, Model bench.

Tools it can use

Settings, Tools it can use

Settings, Tools it can use also has Use these tools from another app: a snippet to paste into an MCP client such as Claude Desktop, with a Copy button; that client can also read your notes (never a private one) and use your skills as prompts. A number Atlas would work out (a sum, a percentage, a conversion, a count of days) comes from the app's own calculator, Calculate, and a date in your words from Read text, so a small model computes nothing in its head; Check answer finds any number its answer says that the notes do not, and Propose act shows a change as a card you confirm. Settings, Tools it can use lists the actions Atlas may take in Agent mode, grouped as Reads your notebook, Changes your notebook, Asks you first and Reaches the web; turn one off and it is never offered. Destructive actions always ask you first, and once Atlas has read a web page, a file, or a note clipped or imported from outside, every change and every web request asks too. How many are offered at once: Only what the message needs (the default) or Always send all of them, if Atlas ever misses a tool you asked for. Small model mode offers a small model one tool at a time (Auto decides from the model's name, On, Off). Run budget caps what one skill run may spend, in tokens per step and in seconds; 0 means no limit. A skill may also cap its own tool calls and steps; a run that passes a cap stops, says which, and keeps its changes for Undo. With small model mode on, a skill measured below 80% on small models shows Needs a larger model, with why. In Agent mode the model's size, read from its name, decides how many tools it sees and how long one step may write: under 3B and up to 8B get a short toolbox and a reply that runs long is cut short, 8B and up get everything.

Autonomous background AI

Settings, Background tasks

Autonomous background AI is turned on in Settings, Background tasks. The background librarian then tags, links and flags duplicate notes on an interval you choose. It is off by default, since it writes to your notebook without being asked each time. It never deletes anything and skips itself on battery power. It also gives a second opinion on notes that were filed by your notebook's own words while no model was available, moving the ones the model files elsewhere.

Web search

Settings, Web search

Web search is opt-in and off by default. Turn it on in Settings, Web search: only your search words are sent out, never your notes, so the assistant can look something up online when asked. With it on and no model running, a Chat question your notes do not answer is answered from the pages found, one line a page under its title, cited by its address. The pages are in the Web results fold under the answer: each with its site and one line; press a title to read the page there, as text, with Back to results, or the arrow beside it to open it in your browser.

Search and index

Settings, Search and index

Settings, Search and index. Search engine: the built-in one (recommended, about 650 MB of memory while the app is open) or an Ollama embedding model such as nomic-embed-text. The built-in one needs the sentence-transformers package (about 2 GB with PyTorch), which Tessellate installs in the background the first time it is needed, with a notice that says so and a Don't install button; the switch Install search by meaning automatically turns that off, and search then uses keywords until you press Install in Settings, Packages. Changing the engine re-reads every note in the background (Background tasks shows it, with Stop) and search keeps using the current model until the new one has read every note. Embedding models lists the choices, from MiniLM (smallest, fastest) and BGE Small (the default) to multilingual ones (Multilingual E5, BGE M3, Qwen3), with each one's size, languages, context and licence, and its state (Downloaded with its size on disk, Not downloaded, or Files missing, with Reinstall; Settings, Packages points here): Use switches in one press, and a model under other terms (EmbeddingGemma) links to them instead; each row's ⋮ has Use, Install or Reinstall, and Uninstall (refused on the model in use). Found on this computer lists embedding models already here (the Hugging Face cache, Ollama, LM Studio), with Use where Tessellate can load them and why not where it cannot. Pull a model by name takes a Hugging Face repo (owner/name) or an Ollama name and checks it online only when you press Pull. Search index: Rebuild search index after an update or a restore, or if search stops finding notes you know are there. Search relevance: Minimum similarity and Above-average margin; raise them for fewer, surer results, lower them if search feels too strict, and Reset to default undoes both.

Packages

Settings, Packages

Settings, Packages lists what Tessellate can do with one more package installed: nothing there is needed to write, search, tag or organise notes, each one switches on a feature that is otherwise off, downloaded from PyPI to this machine. Bundles group the packages one kind of work needs (Documents, Vision, AI, Voice, Desktop, Code, Languages): a bundle's Install fetches what is missing, and its ⋮ reinstalls or removes them all. Tick packages to install, reinstall or remove several at once from the bar above the list; they run one after another and one that fails does not stop the rest; a bundle's row shows each of its packages as it goes, waiting, installing or done. An installed package's ⋮ has Reinstall (for a feature that is on but not working) and Remove, and its row shows its version and size on disk. What pip is doing shows an install as it runs. Dictation model size runs from Tiny (fastest) to Medium (most accurate). Skip silence before transcribing (on) stops Whisper writing words into the quiet around a clip; Dictation language skips the guess; Words to expect lists names and terms it should spell your way. Embedding models lists the built-in models on this machine, each downloaded once and kept; which one search uses is chosen in Settings, Search and index.

Privacy and your data

Privacy

Settings, Privacy

Private notes are encrypted at rest with a key derived from your unlock password. The app binds to localhost, has no account or telemetry, and nothing leaves your machine unless you explicitly turn on web search. Settings, Privacy, Where your data went lists every connection the app made, recorded as it happened, Since launch or All time, one row per place with what it was for (the file downloaded, the search words); its addresses are under Addresses. "Nothing left this computer." means none. The Local chip in the top bar says the same for this launch (Local, Local network or Online) and opens that record; on a phone it is a row in the top bar's More menu.

Account and security

Settings, Account & security

Settings, Account & security: set a password and the notebook asks for it when it opens. The lock button in the top bar locks it now, and it locks itself after the idle time you choose there. While it is locked, an open dialog or popover is put away, and it comes back as it was after you unlock. Private notes are encrypted with that password and are never sent to the AI, so a private note's menu has no AI actions. Forgot it? Press Forgot your password? on the lock screen, on this computer: with a recovery key (made at setup or in Account & security) you set a new one and keep private notes; without it, a reset keeps everything else and leaves private notes sealed. PIN for this computer: Set up a PIN for this computer (your password, then a PIN of 4 to 12 digits twice) lets the lock screen take the PIN or your password, on this computer only; phones always need the password. The computer's own protected store keeps it, never the notebook or a backup. Five wrong PINs, a password change or Forget PIN remove it.

What is encrypted

Settings, Account & security

Private notes are encrypted at rest with a key made from your unlock password; without it their words cannot be read from the data folder. Other notes are stored as they are written, in the data folder on your computer, so your disk's own encryption is what keeps them. A full backup can be sealed with a password (Settings, Import & export). A recovery key (Settings, Account & security) opens private notes if the password is forgotten, and Re-encrypt private notes makes a new key.

Passwords and locking

Settings, Account & security

Settings, Account & security. Signing in: ask for a password when the app opens (private notes and other devices always ask). Other devices: let a phone or computer on your network open the app, always with your password, over https on port 8443, and only on networks you trusted (the wifi icon in the status bar, Alt+L). Ask before a new device signs in holds one until you Allow; Allowed devices have Remove. Loosening needs your password. The first visit warns that the certificate is not trusted: compare its SHA-256 fingerprint with the one under the switch before you continue, and Regenerate certificate makes a new one. Under the fingerprint are the names the certificate carries and when it expires; Trust this certificate on your phone downloads it, and its ? says how to install it on iPhone and Android. If this computer's address changes, the app makes a new certificate straight away. Change your password (private notes move across; a new one needs at least 8 characters, and an easy one gets a warning). Re-encrypt private notes (Settings, Account & security) makes a new encryption key and moves every private note onto it, so an old backup stops opening them; every other session is signed out. Sessions: Auto-lock when idle, from 5 minutes to 12 hours, and Lock everywhere now; the lock in the top bar locks at once. Recovery key: Make a recovery key (or Replace it) asks your password and shows a key once, to copy or download and keep away from this computer; the old one stops working. Forgot your password? on the lock screen, on this computer only, has two paths: the recovery key and a new password keeps private notes and hands you a new key; I don't have it resets the password like python -m tessellate --reset-password, which keeps ordinary notes, documents, boards and settings, leaves private notes sealed for good, and turns other devices off.

On your phone

Settings, Account & security, Other devices

Your phone opens this computer's notebook over your own network: turn on Allow other devices on this network (Settings, Account & security, Other devices), then open the large address it shows (Copy is beside it, and QR code shows a code the phone's camera opens; Other addresses folds the rest) on the phone and sign in with your password. On an iPhone, press Install the certificate on the lock screen, then, in the iPhone's own Settings app, General, VPN and Device Management to install it and About, Certificate Trust Settings to trust it; its ? has the steps. The phone's first sign-in waits until you choose Allow on this computer (a notice with Allow and Deny); allowed devices are listed with Remove. On a network you have not trusted (a cafe, an airport) nothing can reach the notebook until you trust it: the wifi icon in the status bar (Alt+L) says open, closed or off, and its panel has the switch, the address and the trusted and untrusted networks. A phone's hotspot works too, with no restart. If the phone cannot connect, both must be on the same Wi-Fi (not a guest one), this computer's firewall must let the app in (on Windows, Other devices shows the one line to paste into an administrator Command Prompt, for private networks only), and on an iPhone the browser needs Local Network on (the iPhone's Settings app, Privacy & Security, Local Network) with any VPN or ad-blocking app (AdGuard's local VPN) paused. The phone reads and writes the same notebook, and a note changed on one shows on the other within seconds; nothing goes through the internet, so the computer has to be on. A phone never makes this computer act: installing, downloading a model, restoring a backup, quitting, opening a folder and the settings that point this computer elsewhere say Not available on this device, and an export downloads to the phone itself.

Other devices and networks

The wifi icon in the status bar, or Settings, Account & security, Other devices

The wifi icon in the status bar, on this computer only, says whether other devices on your network can open the app: green open, amber closed on this network (one you have not trusted, or no network at all), plain off. Press it, or Alt+L, for its panel (a sheet on a phone-sized window): the switch, the address to type, Trust this network, and two lists, one row per network, named by its Wi-Fi name where this computer can read it, its address range under it. Trusted networks have Stop trusting and Forget; Untrusted networks, every network the app saw and stayed closed on, have Trust (asks your password) and Forget, always on the row. The switch applies at once, with no restart: off closes the port and signs every other device out, and when the wifi drops or you join a network you have not trusted the port closes by itself. Left on and unused for 14 days, it turns itself off and says so in the bell. Each time a phone opens the app, the privacy receipt lists it as a connection coming in, with its address only. A phone can never turn it on, trust a network or loosen a setting: those say Not available on this device.

Two computers

Settings, Import & export

One notebook lives on one computer, in its data folder (Settings, Import & export shows where). There is no sync between two copies. To move to a new computer, save a full backup there and restore it on the new one, or copy the data folder while the app is closed. To use one notebook from a second computer at the same time, open it over your network from the first: Settings, Account & security, Other devices.

Deleting your data

Settings, General, Bin

A deleted note, document or reminder goes to the bin first: Undo or the bin's Restore brings it back, and the bin clears itself after the time set in Settings, General, Bin (or Empty the bin at once). Everything else is in the data folder (Settings, Import & export shows where): to erase the notebook, save a backup if you want one, close the app and delete that folder, then uninstall. Nothing is kept anywhere else.

Where your data lives

Settings, Import & export

Everything lives in a data folder you control: the notebook database, uploads, and daily local backups. Settings, Import & export shows exactly where it is on disk, and lets you export as JSON, CSV or Markdown, export the whole notebook as a folder (Export notebook folder: each note as markdown with its attachments and a .json file of every field, plus documents and boards, which From a Tessellate folder reads back), save a full backup (sealed with a password if you like) and restore one from a file, and manage or restore backups.

Import and export

Settings, Import & export

Settings, Import & export. Export your data as JSON, CSV, Markdown or a full backup (the database, media and attached files as one file, sealed with a password if you type one: a .mmenc, else a .zip); Restore a full backup, just below, reads either back and replaces the notebook after a safety snapshot; Open exports folder and Save exports to set where files land. Tidy up duplicates finds notes that say much the same thing, no AI needed, and merging keeps every tag and bins the rest. Import markdown files or a folder (Obsidian frontmatter is understood), or a PDF, Word file or slide deck, one note per chapter or slide. To keep a file whole as a document you can edit instead, open Library, Documents, the more menu, Import a file as a document. Backups: Back up now, and how many to keep; one is also taken each day the app starts, and restoring snapshots first, so even a restore can be undone. A line above the list gives the schedule, when it last ran and whether that worked, and when the next is due; in the desktop app, Also copy each backup to sends a second copy to a folder you choose, such as an external drive. Each backup row says when in words, marks the newest Latest, and says what made it (the daily backup, Back up now, before an update or a restore), its size and whether it was checked. App cache, at the bottom: Clear app cache reloads the app with fresh files and never touches your notes.

Import from another app

Settings, Import & export, Import from another app

Settings, Import & export, Import from another app has five buttons: From Notion (choose the zip from Notion's Export, Markdown & CSV), From Obsidian (choose the vault folder), From Evernote (choose the .enex files you exported), From Apple Notes (choose the folder an exporter app wrote, one HTML, Markdown or text file per note) and From a Tessellate folder (the zip Export notebook folder writes, every field back as it was). Choosing starts the import and the toast's Undo moves exactly those notes to the recycle bin. Folders and notebooks become categories, tags and dates come along where the app wrote them, and links between Notion pages become wiki links. Each note remembers where it came from, so importing the same export again adds nothing twice and says how many were already here. Imported text is treated as someone else's words: Atlas never follows instructions written in it. A note's day comes from the export where it says one with its year: a daily note named 2024-03-14, a date: or Created: line; that is its day on the Timeline, and "tomorrow" in it means the day after it was written. The import's summary names the people and places it read. Every import keeps a report of what it read, wrote, skipped and found already here, each skipped file named with why: See the report when it ends, or Report in the Activity panel. A long import shows in the Activity panel with Stop; the notes made before Stop stay.

What you use

Settings, General, What you use

Settings, General, What you use counts each tab you open and each command you run from the palette, on this computer only, in a small file in your data folder: names and dates, never what you typed, and never sent anywhere (there is no telemetry). It lists your most used tabs and commands and the ones not used in 90 days, and the command palette lists the commands you use most first. Clear the counts forgets every one.

Background tasks

Settings, Background tasks

Settings, Background tasks shows what the app is doing right now (re-indexing, downloading a model, installing packages, setting up search), each running job with a progress bar (a moving one when it cannot count its steps), how long it has run and who started it, with Stop on the jobs that can stop safely, and what has finished since it started, with how long it took. Every run, a chat answer or an Agent turn too, has its lines in a fold: what it searched, each tool it called, done; live while it runs. Background jobs lists every kind of job, the never-run ones too, with when it last ran and how it went; each scheduled pass (autonomous background AI, the night shift, the daily backup, resurfacing, the embeddings backfill, housekeeping) also says when it runs by itself and has Run now. Beside each control (Back up now, Rebuild search index, Find duplicates, the importers) a line reads, for example, "Last run 2h ago, succeeded, 412 notes indexed", with the exact time on hover; a failure says why in a few words. Ask "what ran overnight" or "when did I last back up" and the answer comes from these records, with times. Autonomous background AI is here too. Battery-efficient mode pauses background AI, heavy graph work and the moving artwork. Quit Tessellate stops the app and its server properly, so the next start finds its port free.

Activity

The status bar's job slot, or the palette, Activity

Activity lists every job running now: indexing, a model loading or answering, imports, reading text, transcribing, backups and the agent's passes, each with a bar, its lines and Stop where it can stop part way. While anything runs, the status bar's job slot says how many and names the newest. Open Activity from it, its agent runs count, or the palette (Activity). Its Agent runs tab lists each run this session with its steps, and the log is in its menu. Stop the model, in the menu and in Settings, Models beside Use this model, stops any answer and unloads the model from memory (Ollama drops it at once); a server this app did not start keeps its own model, and the message says so.

Health

Settings, About, Health

Settings, About, Health says how the notebook is, each line dated: the last backup and when it was taken, the data folder's size, Files on disk (a bar of the notebook, attached files, pictures, backups and optional features), what is running now, the last error in the log, and Integrity, whose Check now has the database check itself and counts the search index beside your notes. The palette's Health goes straight there. The app also gives the notebook file a quick check each time it starts, and if that fails it says so and points to the newest backup in Settings, Import & export.

Settings and support

Your profile

Settings, Profile

Settings, Profile is you, kept on this computer: Your name (shown in the greeting and on your mark), Your look (your face, drawn from your name; Shuffle redraws it and Back to my name's own undoes that, Choose parts yourself sets each part), and About me, which Atlas reads for more personal answers only while "Let Atlas read your name and About me" is on. Delete my profile data clears it; answers just get less personal.

General settings

Settings, General

Settings, General. Bin: auto-clear binned notes, documents, reminders and OCR readings after a number of days. Chat history: delete saved chats after a number of days (0 keeps every chat; pinned chats are never deleted). Notifications: mute everything except reminders. Writing: smart quotes and dashes in documents. Answer style moved to Settings, Personas, and Search relevance to Settings, Search and index.

Updates

Settings, About

Settings, About says which version you have and checks for a newer one; the Windows app can download and install it for you. Choose Stable (releases only) or Main. The first start asks once whether to check for updates automatically, and nothing is checked until you answer. A copy started with start.sh or start.bat then updates itself when it starts, following the same setting, and turning automatic updates off stops it. The Check for updates button checks once, whatever the switch says. Also tell me about beta versions (off by default) makes a check offer a beta or release candidate when it is the highest version.

Maintenance

Settings, About, Maintenance

Settings, About, Maintenance runs the launcher's own actions from the app. Check this computer runs the checks doctor.sh and doctor.bat print (Python, free disk, the port, the model server, the notes folder, the last launch) plus the search model and other devices, each row with a tick, a warning or a cross and what to do. Reinstall on next start rebuilds the app's Python environment the next time start.sh or start.bat opens the app, the same as reinstall.sh; your notes, settings and models are not touched, and Cancel takes it back. A copy from the installer has no environment to rebuild: its Repair shortcut is the way. Open the launcher logs opens the folder the launcher writes to, and Make a desktop shortcut makes the one start --shortcut makes. Uninstall... never removes anything itself: it shows the steps and the command for this computer with Copy, and Export my notes first. These work only on the computer the app runs on; on a phone they are off.

Logs and reporting a problem

Settings, Logs

Settings, Logs shows what happened, for when something did not work: filter by source and level, follow new lines, copy or clear them. The ? beside the three dots in its bar says what each control does. The support bundle collects the logs and the app's state; Email it opens a message to support with the bundle to attach.

When something does not work

Settings, Models, then Settings, Logs

If Atlas does not answer, open Settings, Models: it says whether a model is connected. Start Ollama (or LM Studio, or a llama.cpp server), pick a model and press Connect. Everything except Chat, drafting and skills works without one, and Notes, Ask answers from your notes. Settings, Logs shows the last errors (a finished task's Logs, in Background tasks, opens them filtered to it), which is what to send if you report a problem. If something looks out of date or broken after an update, open Settings, Import & export and press Clear app cache: it reloads the app with fresh files and touches nothing in your notebook. Just below it, Clear and forget removes the recent searches in every search box, the saved previews, the Guide's conversation and the suggestions you dismissed, each with an Undo for ten seconds. Every setting you change is undoable too, from the toast and from Recent changes in the same section (the last twenty).

Credits and licences

Settings, Help, Credits

Settings, Help, Credits lists the libraries and data Tessellate is built on, each with its licence and a link to its source: the ones in the server, the ones in the app, the optional downloads and the whiteboard's shapes. Tessellate itself is AGPL-3.0.